

Ceteris paribus. a Latin phrase meaning other things being equal, used to study one change at a time
Ceteris paribus is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Economic law. a statement of a regular tendency in human choices, true when other things stay equal
Economic law is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Economic Laws is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Economic Laws is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

This section asks what microeconomics and macroeconomics means before applying it.

Model. a simplified picture of a situation that keeps only the features needed to answer a question
Model is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

The term **Ceteris paribus** means a Latin phrase meaning other things being equal, used to study one change at a time. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Base facts carried: bookshop in Dhaka, run in 2026 by Shirin and Imran Meghna, restock decision of 12 January 2026 (Chapter 1 facts need not be repeated beyond this). Records of 5 February 2026: a 200-page exercise book sells at. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in economic laws, before moving to the next step.

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The running case gives the idea a concrete setting without requiring a story or invented motives. The records identify dates, quantities and prices, so the reader can reproduce the reasoning. Where the case gives a number, the number is retained; where it gives a general rule, the explanation remains general rather than creating an unsupported shop record.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in economic laws to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

2.3 | MICROECONOMICS AND MACROECONOMICS |
FRAMEWORK | 450

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Model** means a simplified picture of a situation that keeps only the features needed to answer a question. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Base facts carried: bookshop in Dhaka, run in 2026 by Shirin and Imran Meghna, restock decision of 12 January 2026 (Chapter 1 facts need not be repeated beyond this). Records of 5 February 2026: a 200-page exercise book sells at. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or

THE ELEMENTARY AND PRINCIPLES OF
FINANCE

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OF FINANCE



KUTUSH KUMAR, KUTUM PAKHI

The opening question sets up the problem before the rule is named.

The reader first separates the objects of the analysis.

The running case provides records rather than invented narrative.

This section asks what science, art and normative views means before applying it.

Science. a body of knowledge built by observing facts, forming explanations and testing them
Science is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Suppose you have to make a decision with a limited amount of money, time, space or equipment. Two choices may both be sensible, yet the same resources cannot serve both at once. The economic question is not whether one choice sounds attractive in isolation. It is what follows when the available resource is limited and a choice must be made. Teach the reader how economists argue, what an economic law is, and where microeconomics fits. This chapter develops that reasoning from a concrete setting to a general rule, then returns to the case so the rule can be checked.

Ask what is being chosen, who is making the choice, which quantity is being measured, and which conditions are being held fixed. This order prevents a common mistake: answering a different question from the one the evidence can answer. A price, a quantity, a cost, an input or a payment may appear in the same record, but each has a distinct role. The chapter therefore introduces each working term at its first necessary point and keeps its meaning stable afterwards.

Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Base facts carried: bookshop in Dhaka, run in 2026 by Shirin and Imran Meghna, restock decision of 12 January 2026 (Chapter 1 facts need not be repeated beyond this). Records of 5 February 2026: a 200-page exercise book sells at Tk 60 and 200 copies sell in a week. Ledger note A, in Shirin Meghna's hand: when the price was raised to Tk 66 on 2 March 2026, weekly sales fell to 188. Ledger note B, in Imran Meghna's hand: students should not have to pay more than Tk 60. Note A can be checked against sales records; note B cannot. Regular tendency recorded over three years: textbook sales rise in the two weeks before each term begins (this holds when the shop's prices stay unchanged). Micro and macro: the shop's price and stock are micro matters; the movement of the average price of all goods in Bangladesh is a macro matter. The case is illustrative, so it is used to show how the method works rather than to suggest facts beyond the record. Dates, amounts and decisions are treated as given data. When a conclusion depends on a condition, that condition is stated. When the case does not supply evidence for a claim, the discussion stays at the general level instead of creating a new fact.

* * *

2.1 | SCIENCE, ART AND NORMATIVE VIEWS | NEW
IDEA | 550

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Science** means a body of knowledge built by observing facts, forming explanations and testing them. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Base facts carried: bookshop in Dhaka, run in 2026 by Shirin and Imran Meghna, restock decision of 12 January 2026 (Chapter 1 facts need not be repeated beyond this). Records of 5 February 2026: a 200-page exercise book sells at. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in science, art and normative views, before moving to the next step.

CONTENTS

I. SCARCITY, CHOICE AND THE ECONOMIC PROBLEM	1
1.1 Wants, Resources and Scarcity new idea 775	2
1.2 Choice and Opportunity Cost new idea 550	4
1.3 The Basic Problems of an Economic Organisation framework 550	5
1.4 Defining Economics defining theory 225	6
II. ECONOMIC REASONING, LAWS AND THE SCOPE OF MICROECONOMICS	11
2.1 Science, Art and Normative Views new idea 550	12
2.2 Economic Laws new idea 550	13
2.3 Microeconomics and Macroeconomics framework 450	14
2.4 Scope, Importance and Objectives framework 450	15
III. UTILITY AND DIMINISHING MARGINAL UTILITY	19
3.1 Utility and Satisfaction new idea 775	20
3.2 The Law of Diminishing Marginal Utility defining theory 775	21
3.3 Limitations of the Law framework 450	22
IV. DEMAND AND THE DEMAND CURVE	29
4.1 What Demand Means new idea 450	30
4.2 The Law of Demand defining theory 550	31
4.3 What Moves the Demand Curve new idea 550	33
4.4 Related Goods and Exceptions new idea 450	34
V. ELASTICITY OF DEMAND	39
5.1 Measuring Responsiveness technique 775	40
5.2 Forms of Price Elasticity new idea 450	41
5.3 What Affects Price Elasticity new idea 225	43
5.4 Income and Cross Elasticity technique 550	44
VI. CONSUMER CHOICE: SURPLUS AND INDIFFERENCE CURVES	49
6.1 Consumption and Consumer Surplus new idea 550	50
6.2 Indifference Curves and the Budget Line framework 775	51
6.3 Consumer Equilibrium technique 650	52
VII. SUPPLY AND ELASTICITY OF SUPPLY	59
7.1 The Law of Supply defining theory 550	60
7.2 What Moves the Supply Curve new idea 550	61
7.3 Exceptions to the Law framework 225	62
7.4 Elasticity of Supply technique 775	63
VIII. HOW MARKETS FIND A PRICE	69
8.1 Markets and Market Equilibrium framework 550	70
8.2 Forces Toward Equilibrium new idea 550	71
8.3 Shifts and New Equilibria technique 450	72
8.4 Consumer and Producer Surplus in Practice new idea 450	73
IX. PRODUCTION	79
9.1 The Production Function new idea 650	80
9.2 Short Run and Long Run framework 225	81
9.3 Diminishing Returns defining theory 775	83
9.4 Returns to Scale technique 450	84
X. COSTS OF PRODUCTION	89
10.1 Cost Concepts framework 450	90
10.2 Short-Run Cost Curves technique 775	92
10.3 Long-Run Cost Curves new idea 225	93

TO THE READER

This book is written for readers who are meeting the subject for the first time. It assumes no earlier knowledge. Every new word is explained when it first appears, and the book moves slowly wherever an idea is new or difficult.

Beside most paragraphs you will find a note in the narrow column at the edge of the page. A note in italics gives the main point of the paragraph in one line. Read these notes first to see the shape of a chapter, and again when you review.

A word in **bold type** is a new term. It is shown in bold once, where it is first explained, and its meaning is repeated in the narrow column. After that the word appears in ordinary type. Italics are used for emphasis, for foreign words and for the titles of books.¹

Where an everyday word has a special meaning here, a note marked "Word in use" says so. Where an idea is both new and hard, a note reads "Go slowly here", and the text slows down with it.

HOW A CHAPTER RUNS

A chapter opens with a puzzle, then builds its ideas one section at a time. Each section ends with a short recap. The chapter closes with a summary, a problem to think through, the common mistakes people make, a true account from history, and review questions. Questions are numbered, such as 7.1, and their answers are collected at the back of the book.

When a chapter points to another part of the book, it names the chapter and the section, for example Chapter 3, section 3.2. Use the Contents to find it. At the back you will find a glossary of every term, the answers to the questions, a list of further reading, and an index.

This book teaches The Elementary and Principles of Finance one idea at a time, from the very beginning.

The narrow column beside the text holds short notes.

Key term. A new word, shown in bold where it first appears, with its meaning in one line.

A bold word is a new term, and its meaning waits beside it.

Some everyday words have a second, special meaning in this subject.

Each chapter has the same shape, so you always know where you are.

Chapters refer to one another by name, never by page.

return to the earlier step rather than adjusting the conclusion to fit the expected answer.

* * *

SUMMARY

Show why every society and every shop must choose, and give the reader the first working words of economics. The key terms now have fixed meanings, the running case has shown their use, and the limits of the rules have been kept visible. The next chapter can therefore treat these ideas as working tools rather than introduce them again from the beginning.

THINK IT THROUGH

1.T1 scarcity versus shortage, forgone value of a choice made from a new price list, which of the three problems a given decision belongs to

1.T2 a student has Tk 9,000 and one free Saturday and must pick between two paid tasks and a course fee — name the opportunity cost

WHERE PEOPLE GO WRONG

Correction. State the condition first. Then decide whether the new situation still satisfies it. If it does, the rule can be applied again; if it does not, the analysis must be adjusted.

Correction. A number becomes useful only after its unit, period and economic meaning are identified. Always say what the result measures and which figures produced it.

IN HISTORY

The entry directs attention to US petrol shortage after the October 1973 oil embargo, with queues and the odd-even plate rationing of 1974; search: 1973 oil embargo gasoline lines odd-even rationing. This account is used only for the historical connection specified by the chapter. It illustrates why the economic problem mattered in practice, while the chapter's analytical rules remain separate from the historical narrative.

SOURCES

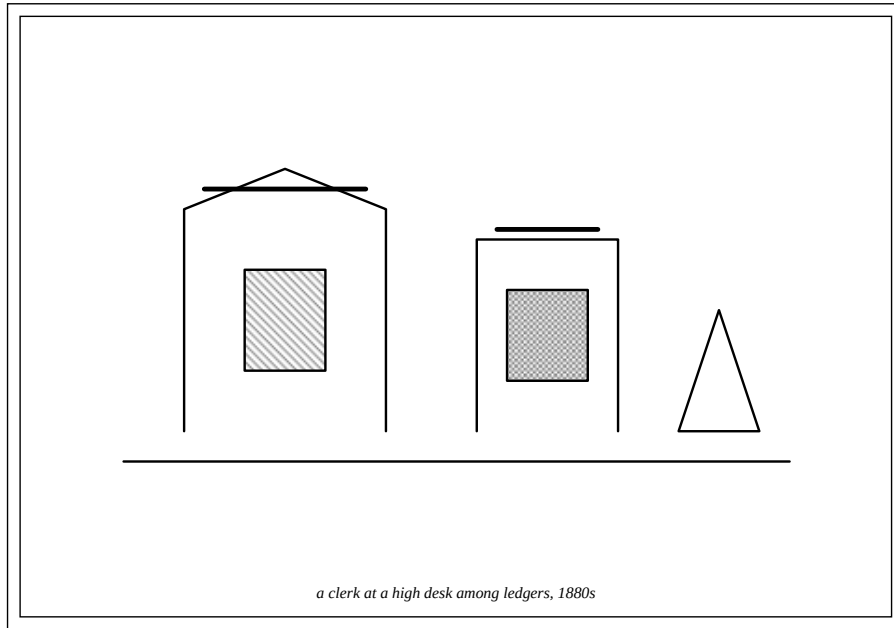
Further reading and historical attribution should be checked against the original works and reliable archival or institutional sources. The chapter does not require the reader to accept a historical interpretation merely because it appears in a secondary account.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

1.3 scarcity versus shortage, forgone value of a choice made from a new price list, which of the three problems a given decision belongs to

1.4 a student has Tk 9,000 and one free Saturday and must pick between two paid tasks and a course fee — name the opportunity cost

¹ A footnote gives a side point that would interrupt the main argument. Footnotes are numbered within each chapter and appear at the foot of the page.



CHAPTER I

Scarcity, Choice and the Economic Problem

What does this chapter let us explain that the earlier ideas could not explain alone?



Show why every society and every shop must choose, and give the reader the first working words of economics. The chapter builds the idea in small stages, then applies it to the running case. The examples keep the stated conditions visible so the reasoning can be checked.

The Basic Problems of an Economic Organisation is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The Basic Problems of an Economic Organisation is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

This section asks what defining economics means before applying it.

Economic system. the set of rules and institutions a country uses to answer its basic economic problems

Economic system is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Defining Economics is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Defining Economics is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

precisely what is being measured or compared in the basic problems of an economic organisation, before moving to the next step.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

There is also a limit to the rule. Economic relationships describe tendencies under stated conditions, not mechanical laws that ignore every other fact. If a condition changes, the result may change as well. A careful reader therefore states the condition before applying the rule and checks whether the new situation still satisfies it.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in the basic problems of an economic organisation to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

1.4 | DEFINING ECONOMICS | DEFINING THEORY | 225

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Economic system** means the set of rules and institutions a country uses to answer its basic economic problems. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons is an illustrative documented case file. Base facts (FIXED): a bookshop in Dhaka opened on 4 January 2004 by Abdul Meghna; in 2026 run by his daughter Shirin Meghna and his son Imran Meghna; one shop of 600 square feet. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in defining economics, before moving to the next step.

There is also a limit to the rule. Economic relationships describe tendencies under stated conditions, not mechanical laws that ignore every other fact. If a condition changes, the result may change as well. A careful reader therefore states the condition before applying the rule and checks whether the new situation still satisfies it.

The central question in defining economics is how a decision follows from limited information and a stated rule. A useful first step is to name the objects being compared, then keep the conditions fixed while one relationship is examined. This prevents several different causes from being mixed together. The result is a description that can be checked against the figures or the stated situation.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in defining economics to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion

The term **Want** means something a person would like to have, whether or not they can pay for it. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons is an illustrative documented case file. Base facts (FIXED): a bookshop in Dhaka opened on 4 January 2004 by Abdul Meghna; in 2026 run by his daughter Shirin Meghna and his son Imran Meghna; one shop of 600 square feet. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in wants, resources and scarcity, before moving to the next step.

The term **Resource** means anything used to make goods and services: land, labour, capital and enterprise. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons is an illustrative documented case file. Base facts (FIXED): a bookshop in Dhaka opened on 4 January 2004 by Abdul Meghna; in 2026 run by his daughter Shirin Meghna and his son Imran Meghna; one shop of 600 square feet. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in wants, resources and scarcity, before moving to the next step.

The term **Factor of production** means one of the four kinds of resource used in making things: land, labour, capital, enterprise. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons is an illustrative documented case file. Base facts (FIXED): a bookshop in Dhaka opened on 4 January 2004 by Abdul Meghna; in 2026 run by his daughter Shirin Meghna and his son Imran Meghna; one shop of 600 square feet. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in wants, resources and scarcity, before moving to the next step.

A beginner can read this idea in two stages. First, ask what changes and what stays unchanged. Next, ask what the change does to the quantity, cost, price, satisfaction or output under discussion. The distinction is small in wording but large in analysis, because the same numerical change can have different meanings when the underlying condition is different.

The running case gives the idea a concrete setting without requiring a story or invented motives. The records identify dates, quantities and prices, so the reader can reproduce the reasoning. Where the case gives a number, the number is retained; where it gives a general rule, the explanation remains general rather than creating an unsupported shop record.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in wants, resources and scarcity to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

Want. something a person would like to have, whether or not they can pay for it

Want is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Resource. anything used to make goods and services: land, labour, capital and enterprise

Resource is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Factor of production. one of the four kinds of resource used in making things: land, labour, capital, enterprise

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The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

1.2 | CHOICE AND OPPORTUNITY COST | NEW IDEA | 550

This section asks what choice and opportunity cost means before applying it.

Good. a physical thing people buy to satisfy a want, such as a book or a pen

Good is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Service. an activity done for someone, such as binding a thesis or delivering parcels

Service is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Scarcity. the condition in which resources are too few to satisfy all the wants people have

Scarcity is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Choice. picking one option and giving up the others because resources cannot cover every option

Choice is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Choice and Opportunity Cost is understood by separating the question into small steps.

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The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Good** means a physical thing people buy to satisfy a want, such as a book or a pen. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons is an illustrative documented case file. Base facts (FIXED): a bookshop in Dhaka opened on 4 January 2004 by Abdul Meghna; in 2026 run by his daughter Shirin Meghna and his son Imran Meghna; one shop of 600 square feet. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in choice and opportunity cost, before moving to the next step.

The term **Service** means an activity done for someone, such as binding a thesis or delivering parcels. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons is an illustrative documented case file. Base facts (FIXED): a bookshop in Dhaka opened on 4 January 2004 by Abdul Meghna; in 2026 run by his daughter Shirin Meghna and his son Imran Meghna; one shop of 600 square feet. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in choice and opportunity cost, before moving to the next step.

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The term **Choice** means picking one option and giving up the others because resources cannot cover every option. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons is an illustrative documented case file. Base facts (FIXED): a bookshop in Dhaka opened on 4 January 2004 by Abdul Meghna; in 2026 run by his daughter Shirin Meghna and his son Imran Meghna; one shop of 600 square feet. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in choice and opportunity cost, before moving to the next step.

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The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because

The reader should separate the starting condition from the change being examined, then identify the quantity that responds. This prevents a movement from being confused with a shift, a total from being confused with a marginal amount, or a descriptive fact from being confused with a judgement. The running case provides fixed figures, but the reasoning is broader: identify the relevant definition, state the condition, apply the relationship, and check the result against the original data. If one condition changes, the analysis must be repeated rather than carried over unchanged. This disciplined sequence is the main practical skill developed by the chapter.

The reader should separate the starting condition from the change being examined, then identify the quantity that responds. This prevents a movement from being confused with a shift, a total from being confused with a marginal amount, or a descriptive fact from being confused with a judgement. The running case provides fixed figures, but the reasoning is broader: identify the relevant definition, state the condition, apply the relationship, and check the result against the original data. If one condition changes, the analysis must be repeated rather than carried over unchanged. This disciplined sequence is the main practical skill developed by the chapter.

WORKED CASE: THE RUNNING RECORD

Situation. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Base facts carried: bookshop in Dhaka, run in 2026 by Shirin and Imran Meghna, restock decision of 12 January 2026 (Chapter 1 facts need not be repeated beyond this). Records of 5 February 2026: a 200-page exercise book sells at Tk 60 and 200 copies sell in a week. Ledger note A, in Shirin Meghna's hand: when the price was raised to Tk 66 on 2 March 2026, weekly sales fell to 188. Ledger note B, in Imran Meghna's hand: students should not have to pay more than Tk 60. Note A can be checked against sales records; note B cannot. Regular tendency recorded over three years: textbook sales rise in the two weeks before each term begins (this holds when the shop's prices stay unchanged). Micro and macro: the shop's price and stock are micro matters; the movement of the average price of all goods in Bangladesh is a macro matter. Question. What does the record show when the chapter's central rule is applied to these facts?

Reasoning. Begin by listing the given figures and identifying the relationship that the chapter explains. Where arithmetic is needed, write the starting figures first, then the change, then the result. Where the issue is descriptive, name the category and give the condition that places the case in that category. This keeps the method reproducible: another reader should be able to follow the same sequence and reach the same conclusion from the stated record.

Conclusion. The record illustrates the chapter's central relationship in a controlled setting. It does not prove that the same result must occur in every market, firm or household. The value of the worked case is that it shows how a general idea is applied while the assumptions remain visible.

Check. Re-read the quantities, prices, costs or inputs used in the calculation. Confirm that units and periods match and that no figure has been silently changed. If the result contradicts a stated fact, return to the earlier step rather than adjusting the conclusion to fit the expected answer.

* * *

The same method remains useful when the surrounding details change.

The same method remains useful when the surrounding details change.

The worked case applies the chapter without adding facts to the record.

The reasoning follows the data rather than an invented story.

The conclusion is limited to what the case supports.

A final check asks whether the result fits the original data.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

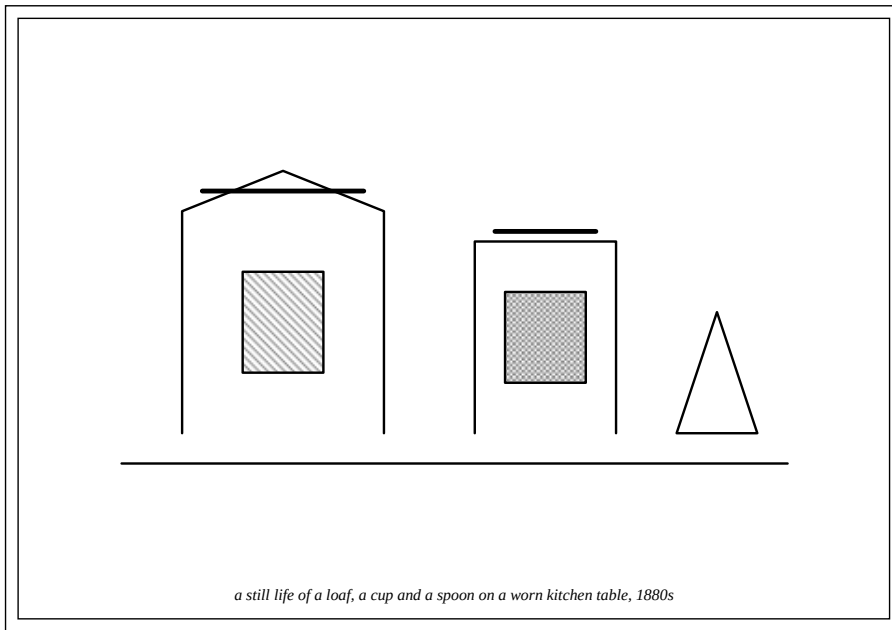
4.3 draw a curve from a new schedule, tell a movement from a shift in five events, say how a pen-pack price change affects notebook demand

4.4 when the price of petrol rises, say what probably happens to demand for natural gas and why

4.5 after the movement-versus-shift passage and after the exceptions passage

PAUSE AND CHECK 4.P6 after the movement-versus-shift passage

PAUSE AND CHECK 4.P7 the exceptions passage



CHAPTER III

Utility and Diminishing Marginal Utility

What does this chapter let us explain that the earlier ideas could not explain alone?



Explain satisfaction as the root of demand and give the first law the reader can test. The chapter builds the idea in small stages, then applies it to the running case. The examples keep the stated conditions visible so the reasoning can be checked.

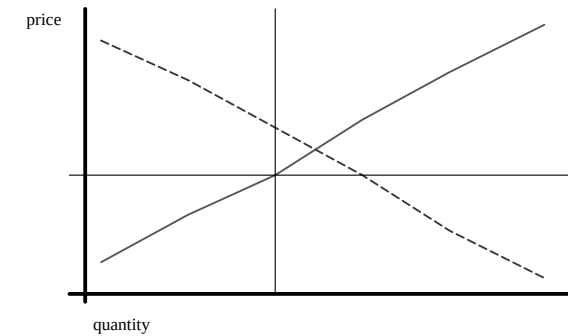


FIG. 4.3. a rightward and a leftward shift with the causes labelled

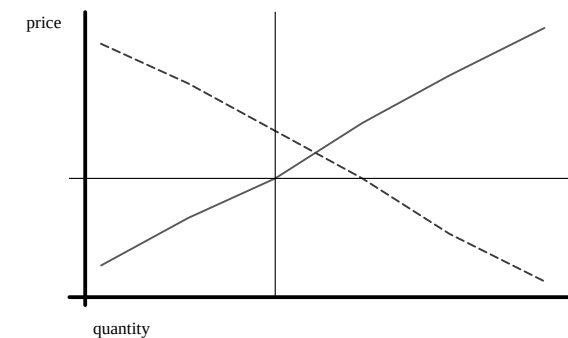


FIG. 4.4. the curve of an exceptional good that bends upward, with the snob and bandwagon cases beside it

WORKED CASE: THE RUNNING RECORD

The worked case applies the chapter without adding facts to the record.

Situation. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Five-week trial from 26 January to 27 February 2026, one price per week, 200-page exercise book. Weekly sales: Tk 50, 240 copies; Tk 55, 220; Tk 60, 200; Tk 66, 188; Tk 70, 180. Shock to determinants: schools announced a drawing term on 10 March 2026, and weekly sales at Tk 60 rose from 200 to 230 (a shift of the curve). Complements: when pen-pack price was cut from Tk 100 to Tk 90 on 16 March 2026, notebook sales at Tk 60 rose from 200 to 210 a week. Substitutes: when the price of a second-hand prescribed textbook fell by 20 per cent, weekly sales of the new copy fell from 50 to 44 (new copy price Tk 700). Snob effect: a numbered edition at Tk 2,400 sold out in three days, while the unnumbered Tk 1,200 edition took three weeks. Bandwagon effect: a title at Tk 450 sold 20 copies a week until it topped a public bestseller list, then 85 a week. Giffen good: no case in the shop; explain only in general terms. Question.

being measured or compared in utility and satisfaction, before moving to the next step.

The term **Total utility** means the whole satisfaction from all the units of a good consumed in a period. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Survey card of 10 February 2026 for one regular customer, satisfaction scored in utils for notebooks bought in one visit: first notebook 20 utils, second 14, third 9, fourth 5, fifth 2. Derived (by code in the writer's check): t. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in utility and satisfaction, before moving to the next step.

A beginner can read this idea in two stages. First, ask what changes and what stays unchanged. Next, ask what the change does to the quantity, cost, price, satisfaction or output under discussion. The distinction is small in wording but large in analysis, because the same numerical change can have different meanings when the underlying condition is different.

The running case gives the idea a concrete setting without requiring a story or invented motives. The records identify dates, quantities and prices, so the reader can reproduce the reasoning. Where the case gives a number, the number is retained; where it gives a general rule, the explanation remains general rather than creating an unsupported shop record.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in utility and satisfaction to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

3.2 | THE LAW OF DIMINISHING MARGINAL UTILITY | DEFINING THEORY | 775

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Marginal utility** means the extra satisfaction gained from consuming one more unit of a good. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Survey card of 10 February 2026 for one regular customer, satisfaction scored in utils for notebooks bought in one visit: first notebook 20 utils, second 14, third 9, fourth 5, fifth 2. Derived (by code in the writer's check): t. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in the law of diminishing marginal utility, before moving to the next step.

Total utility. the whole satisfaction from all the units of a good consumed in a period
Total utility is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Utility and Satisfaction is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Utility and Satisfaction is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Utility and Satisfaction is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

This section asks what the law of diminishing marginal utility means before applying it.

Marginal utility. the extra satisfaction gained from consuming one more unit of a good
Marginal utility is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

condition before applying the rule and checks whether the new situation still satisfies it.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in what moves the demand curve to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

4.4 | RELATED GOODS AND EXCEPTIONS | NEW IDEA | 450

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Giffen good** means a rare inferior good for which a price rise leads buyers to buy more of it. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Five-week trial from 26 January to 27 February 2026, one price per week, 200-page exercise book. Weekly sales: Tk 50, 240 copies; Tk 55, 220; Tk 60, 200; Tk 66, 188. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in related goods and exceptions, before moving to the next step.

The term **Snob effect** means a fall in demand for a good because more people begin to own it. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Five-week trial from 26 January to 27 February 2026, one price per week, 200-page exercise book. Weekly sales: Tk 50, 240 copies; Tk 55, 220; Tk 60, 200; Tk 66, 188. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in related goods and exceptions, before moving to the next step.

The term **Bandwagon effect** means a rise in demand for a good because more people are seen to buy it. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Five-week trial from 26 January to 27 February 2026, one price per week, 200-page exercise book. Weekly sales: Tk 50, 240 copies; Tk 55, 220; Tk 60, 200; Tk 66, 188. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in related goods and exceptions, before moving to the next step.

There is also a limit to the rule. Economic relationships describe tendencies under stated conditions, not mechanical laws that ignore every other fact. If a condition changes, the result may change as well. A careful reader therefore states the condition before applying the rule and checks whether the new situation still satisfies it.

The central question in related goods and exceptions is how a decision follows from limited information and a stated rule. A useful first step is to name the objects being compared, then keep the conditions fixed while one relationship is examined. This prevents several different causes from being mixed together. The

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

This section asks what related goods and exceptions means before applying it.

Giffen good. a rare inferior good for which a price rise leads buyers to buy more of it

Giffen good is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Snob effect. a fall in demand for a good because more people begin to own it

Snob effect is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Bandwagon effect. a rise in demand for a good because more people are seen to buy it

Bandwagon effect is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Related Goods and Exceptions is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Related Goods and Exceptions is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The term **Ordinal measurement** means ranking satisfaction as first, second and third without giving it a number. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Survey card of 10 February 2026 for one regular customer, satisfaction scored in utils for notebooks bought in one visit: first notebook 20 utils, second 14, third 9, fourth 5, fifth 2. Derived (by code in the writer's check): t. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in limitations of the law, before moving to the next step.

The term **Law of diminishing marginal utility** means as a person consumes more units of a good, the extra satisfaction from each further unit falls. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Survey card of 10 February 2026 for one regular customer, satisfaction scored in utils for notebooks bought in one visit: first notebook 20 utils, second 14, third 9, fourth 5, fifth 2. Derived (by code in the writer's check): t. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in limitations of the law, before moving to the next step.

The term **Saturation point** means the quantity at which marginal utility reaches zero and total utility stops rising. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Survey card of 10 February 2026 for one regular customer, satisfaction scored in utils for notebooks bought in one visit: first notebook 20 utils, second 14, third 9, fourth 5, fifth 2. Derived (by code in the writer's check): t. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in limitations of the law, before moving to the next step.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

There is also a limit to the rule. Economic relationships describe tendencies under stated conditions, not mechanical laws that ignore every other fact. If a condition changes, the result may change as well. A careful reader therefore states the condition before applying the rule and checks whether the new situation still satisfies it.

The central question in limitations of the law is how a decision follows from limited information and a stated rule. A useful first step is to name the objects being compared, then keep the conditions fixed while one relationship is examined. This prevents several different causes from being mixed together. The result is a description that can be checked against the figures or the stated situation.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in limitations of the law to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

Ordinal measurement. ranking satisfaction as first, second and third without giving it a number

Ordinal measurement is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Law of diminishing marginal utility. as a person consumes more units of a good, the extra satisfaction from each further unit falls

Law of diminishing marginal utility is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Saturation point. the quantity at which marginal utility reaches zero and total utility stops rising

Saturation point is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Limitations of the Law is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Limitations of the Law is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Limitations of the Law is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Market** means any arrangement that brings buyers and sellers of a good together. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Five-week trial from 26 January to 27 February 2026, one price per week, 200-page exercise book. Weekly sales: Tk 50, 240 copies; Tk 55, 220; Tk 60, 200; Tk 66, 188. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in the law of demand, before moving to the next step.

The term **Market demand** means the sum of all individual buyers' demands for a good at each price. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Five-week trial from 26 January to 27 February 2026, one price per week, 200-page exercise book. Weekly sales: Tk 50, 240 copies; Tk 55, 220; Tk 60, 200; Tk 66, 188. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in the law of demand, before moving to the next step.

The term **Law of demand** means when the price of a good rises, quantity demanded falls, and when it falls, quantity demanded rises, other things equal. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Five-week trial from 26 January to 27 February 2026, one price per week, 200-page exercise book. Weekly sales: Tk 50, 240 copies; Tk 55, 220; Tk 60, 200; Tk 66, 188. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in the law of demand, before moving to the next step.

The term **Determinants of demand** means the things other than the good's own price that change how much people want to buy. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Five-week trial from 26 January to 27 February 2026, one price per week, 200-page exercise book. Weekly sales: Tk 50, 240 copies; Tk 55, 220; Tk 60, 200; Tk 66, 188. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in the law of demand, before moving to the next step.

The running case gives the idea a concrete setting without requiring a story or invented motives. The records identify dates, quantities and prices, so the reader can reproduce the reasoning. Where the case gives a number, the number is retained; where it gives a general rule, the explanation remains general rather than creating an unsupported shop record.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in the law of demand to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

Market. any arrangement that brings buyers and sellers of a good together

Market is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Market demand. the sum of all individual buyers' demands for a good at each price

Market demand is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Law of demand. when the price of a good rises, quantity demanded falls, and when it falls, quantity demanded rises, other things equal

Law of demand is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Determinants of demand. the things other than the good's own price that change how much people want to buy

Determinants of demand is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

The Law of Demand is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The Law of Demand is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

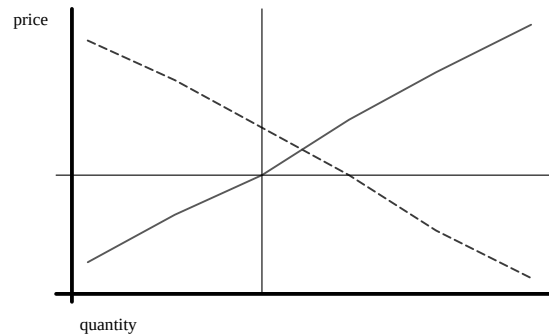


FIG. 3.3. one panel pairing total and marginal utility so the reader sees their link

The reader should separate the starting condition from the change being examined, then identify the quantity that responds. This prevents a movement from being confused with a shift, a total from being confused with a marginal amount, or a descriptive fact from being confused with a judgement. The running case provides fixed figures, but the reasoning is broader: identify the relevant definition, state the condition, apply the relationship, and check the result against the original data. If one condition changes, the analysis must be repeated rather than carried over unchanged. This disciplined sequence is the main practical skill developed by the chapter.

The reader should separate the starting condition from the change being examined, then identify the quantity that responds. This prevents a movement from being confused with a shift, a total from being confused with a marginal amount, or a descriptive fact from being confused with a judgement. The running case provides fixed figures, but the reasoning is broader: identify the relevant definition, state the condition, apply the relationship, and check the result against the original data. If one condition changes, the analysis must be repeated rather than carried over unchanged. This disciplined sequence is the main practical skill developed by the chapter.

The reader should separate the starting condition from the change being examined, then identify the quantity that responds. This prevents a movement from being confused with a shift, a total from being confused with a marginal amount, or a descriptive fact from being confused with a judgement. The running case provides fixed figures, but the reasoning is broader: identify the relevant definition, state the condition, apply the relationship, and check the result against the original data. If one condition changes, the analysis must be repeated rather than carried over unchanged. This disciplined sequence is the main practical skill developed by the chapter.

The reader should separate the starting condition from the change being examined, then identify the quantity that responds. This prevents a movement from being confused with a shift, a total from being confused with a marginal amount, or a descriptive fact from being confused with a judgement. The running case provides fixed figures, but the reasoning is broader: identify the relevant definition, state the condition, apply the relationship, and check the result against the original data. If one condition changes, the analysis must be repeated

The same method remains useful when the surrounding details change.

The same method remains useful when the surrounding details change.

The same method remains useful when the surrounding details change.

The same method remains useful when the surrounding details change.

The opening question sets up the problem before the rule is named.

The reader first separates the objects of the analysis.

The running case provides records rather than invented narrative.

Suppose you have to make a decision with a limited amount of money, time, space or equipment. Two choices may both be sensible, yet the same resources cannot serve both at once. The economic question is not whether one choice sounds attractive in isolation. It is what follows when the available resource is limited and a choice must be made. Build the demand idea from a price table to a curve, and show what moves along it and what shifts it. This chapter develops that reasoning from a concrete setting to a general rule, then returns to the case so the rule can be checked.

Ask what is being chosen, who is making the choice, which quantity is being measured, and which conditions are being held fixed. This order prevents a common mistake: answering a different question from the one the evidence can answer. A price, a quantity, a cost, an input or a payment may appear in the same record, but each has a distinct role. The chapter therefore introduces each working term at its first necessary point and keeps its meaning stable afterwards.

Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Five-week trial from 26 January to 27 February 2026, one price per week, 200-page exercise book. Weekly sales: Tk 50, 240 copies; Tk 55, 220; Tk 60, 200; Tk 66, 188; Tk 70, 180. Shock to determinants: schools announced a drawing term on 10 March 2026, and weekly sales at Tk 60 rose from 200 to 230 (a shift of the curve). Complements: when pen-pack price was cut from Tk 100 to Tk 90 on 16 March 2026, notebook sales at Tk 60 rose from 200 to 210 a week. Substitutes: when the price of a second-hand prescribed textbook fell by 20 per cent, weekly sales of the new copy fell from 50 to 44 (new copy price Tk 700). Snob effect: a numbered edition at Tk 2,400 sold out in three days, while the unnumbered Tk 1,200 edition took three weeks. Bandwagon effect: a title at Tk 450 sold 20 copies a week until it topped a public bestseller list, then 85 a week. Giffen good: no case in the shop; explain only in general terms. The case is illustrative, so it is used to show how the method works rather than to suggest facts beyond the record. Dates, amounts and decisions are treated as given data. When a conclusion depends on a condition, that condition is stated. When the case does not supply evidence for a claim, the discussion stays at the general level instead of creating a new fact.

* * *

4.1 | WHAT DEMAND MEANS | NEW IDEA | 450

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Demand** means the quantity of a good people are willing and able to buy at each possible price, in a given period. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Five-week trial from 26 January to 27 February 2026, one price per week, 200-page exercise book. Weekly sales: Tk 50, 240 copies; Tk 55, 220; Tk 60, 200; Tk 66, 188. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in what demand means, before moving to the next step.

This section asks what what demand means means before applying it.

Demand. the quantity of a good people are willing and able to buy at each possible price, in a given period

Demand is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

3.T2 a diner eats from a buffet — find where marginal utility reaches zero and say what a sensible diner does next

WHERE PEOPLE GO WRONG

Correction. State the condition first. Then decide whether the new situation still satisfies it. If it does, the rule can be applied again; if it does not, the analysis must be adjusted.

Correction. A number becomes useful only after its unit, period and economic meaning are identified. Always say what the result measures and which figures produced it.

A common error is to apply a rule after its condition has changed.

Another error is to confuse a numerical result with the meaning of that result.

IN HISTORY

The entry directs attention to The marginal revolution of 1871 to 1874: Jevons, Menger and Walras explain the diamond-and-water puzzle; search: marginal revolution 1871 Jevons Menger diamond water paradox. This account is used only for the historical connection specified by the chapter. It illustrates why the economic problem mattered in practice, while the chapter's analytical rules remain separate from the historical narrative.

The historical case shows the chapter idea in a documented setting.

SOURCES

Further reading and historical attribution should be checked against the original works and reliable archival or institutional sources. The chapter does not require the reader to accept a historical interpretation merely because it appears in a secondary account.

The chapter uses a small number of historical references to anchor its defining ideas.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

3.3 complete a total-and-marginal table from new scores, state the law with its conditions, give one apparent exception and say why it is not one

3.4 a diner eats from a buffet — find where marginal utility reaches zero and say what a sensible diner does next

3.5 after the total-versus-marginal passage and after the reasons-it-falls passage

PAUSE AND CHECK 3.P6 after the total-versus-marginal passage

PAUSE AND CHECK 3.P7 the reasons-it-falls passage

The term **Percentage change** means the size of a change divided by the starting value, multiplied by 100. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Price elasticity: 200-page exercise book, price rose from Tk 60 to Tk 66 on 2 March 2026; weekly sales fell from 200 to 188. Clean figures: price change +10 per cent, quantity change -6 per cent, elasticity 0.6 (inelastic). In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in measuring responsiveness, before moving to the next step.

The term **Price elasticity of demand** means the percentage change in quantity demanded divided by the percentage change in price. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Price elasticity: 200-page exercise book, price rose from Tk 60 to Tk 66 on 2 March 2026; weekly sales fell from 200 to 188. Clean figures: price change +10 per cent, quantity change -6 per cent, elasticity 0.6 (inelastic). In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in measuring responsiveness, before moving to the next step.

A beginner can read this idea in two stages. First, ask what changes and what stays unchanged. Next, ask what the change does to the quantity, cost, price, satisfaction or output under discussion. The distinction is small in wording but large in analysis, because the same numerical change can have different meanings when the underlying condition is different.

The running case gives the idea a concrete setting without requiring a story or invented motives. The records identify dates, quantities and prices, so the reader can reproduce the reasoning. Where the case gives a number, the number is retained; where it gives a general rule, the explanation remains general rather than creating an unsupported shop record.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in measuring responsiveness to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

5.2 | FORMS OF PRICE ELASTICITY | NEW IDEA | 450

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

Percentage change. the size of a change divided by the starting value, multiplied by 100

Percentage change is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Price elasticity of demand. the percentage change in quantity demanded divided by the percentage change in price

Price elasticity of demand is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Measuring Responsiveness is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Measuring Responsiveness is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Measuring Responsiveness is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

This section asks what forms of price elasticity means before applying it.

Determinants of supply. the things other than the good's own price that change how much sellers offer

Determinants of supply is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

What Moves the Supply Curve is understood by separating the question into small steps.

What Moves the Supply Curve is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

This section asks what exceptions to the law means before applying it.

Backward-bending supply curve. a curve showing that beyond some pay level a worker offers fewer hours as pay rises further

Backward-bending supply curve is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Price elasticity of supply. the percentage change in quantity supplied divided by the percentage change in price

Price elasticity of supply is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

measured or compared in what moves the supply curve, before moving to the next step.

The term **Determinants of supply** means the things other than the good's own price that change how much sellers offer. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). A local printer supplies 200-page exercise books to the shop at a wholesale price. Weekly quantity offered, 9 March 2026: Tk 40, 150 books; Tk 45, 200; Tk 50, 250; Tk 55, 300. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in what moves the supply curve, before moving to the next step.

The running case gives the idea a concrete setting without requiring a story or invented motives. The records identify dates, quantities and prices, so the reader can reproduce the reasoning. Where the case gives a number, the number is retained; where it gives a general rule, the explanation remains general rather than creating an unsupported shop record.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in what moves the supply curve to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

7.3 | EXCEPTIONS TO THE LAW | FRAMEWORK | 225

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Backward-bending supply curve** means a curve showing that beyond some pay level a worker offers fewer hours as pay rises further. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). A local printer supplies 200-page exercise books to the shop at a wholesale price. Weekly quantity offered, 9 March 2026: Tk 40, 150 books; Tk 45, 200; Tk 50, 250; Tk 55, 300. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in exceptions to the law, before moving to the next step.

The term **Price elasticity of supply** means the percentage change in quantity supplied divided by the percentage change in price. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). A local printer supplies 200-page exercise books to the shop at a wholesale price. Weekly quantity offered, 9 March 2026: Tk 40, 150 books; Tk 45, 200; Tk 50, 250; Tk 55, 300. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is

5.3 | WHAT AFFECTS PRICE ELASTICITY | NEW IDEA | 225

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Perfectly elastic demand** means demand that vanishes completely for any price rise, however small, shown as a flat curve. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Price elasticity: 200-page exercise book, price rose from Tk 60 to Tk 66 on 2 March 2026; weekly sales fell from 200 to 188. Clean figures: price change +10 per cent, quantity change -6 per cent, elasticity 0.6 (inelastic). In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in what affects price elasticity, before moving to the next step.

The term **Perfectly inelastic demand** means demand that does not change at all when price changes, shown as a vertical curve. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Price elasticity: 200-page exercise book, price rose from Tk 60 to Tk 66 on 2 March 2026; weekly sales fell from 200 to 188. Clean figures: price change +10 per cent, quantity change -6 per cent, elasticity 0.6 (inelastic). In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in what affects price elasticity, before moving to the next step.

The term **Total revenue** means the money a seller receives from sales, found by price multiplied by quantity sold. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Price elasticity: 200-page exercise book, price rose from Tk 60 to Tk 66 on 2 March 2026; weekly sales fell from 200 to 188. Clean figures: price change +10 per cent, quantity change -6 per cent, elasticity 0.6 (inelastic). In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in what affects price elasticity, before moving to the next step.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

There is also a limit to the rule. Economic relationships describe tendencies under stated conditions, not mechanical laws that ignore every other fact. If a condition changes, the result may change as well. A careful reader therefore states the condition before applying the rule and checks whether the new situation still satisfies it.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in what affects price elasticity to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

This section asks what what affects price elasticity means before applying it.

Perfectly elastic demand. demand that vanishes completely for any price rise, however small, shown as a flat curve

Perfectly elastic demand is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Perfectly inelastic demand. demand that does not change at all when price changes, shown as a vertical curve

Perfectly inelastic demand is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Total revenue. the money a seller receives from sales, found by price multiplied by quantity sold

Total revenue is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

What Affects Price Elasticity is understood by separating the question into small steps.

What Affects Price Elasticity is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

The opening question sets up the problem before the rule is named.

The reader first separates the objects of the analysis.

The running case provides records rather than invented narrative.

This section asks what the law of supply means before applying it.

Supply. the quantity of a good sellers are willing and able to offer at each possible price, in a given period

Supply is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Quantity supplied. the amount sellers plan to offer at one particular price

Quantity supplied is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Suppose you have to make a decision with a limited amount of money, time, space or equipment. Two choices may both be sensible, yet the same resources cannot serve both at once. The economic question is not whether one choice sounds attractive in isolation. It is what follows when the available resource is limited and a choice must be made. Build the supply idea from a price table to a curve and measure how strongly sellers respond to price. This chapter develops that reasoning from a concrete setting to a general rule, then returns to the case so the rule can be checked.

Ask what is being chosen, who is making the choice, which quantity is being measured, and which conditions are being held fixed. This order prevents a common mistake: answering a different question from the one the evidence can answer. A price, a quantity, a cost, an input or a payment may appear in the same record, but each has a distinct role. The chapter therefore introduces each working term at its first necessary point and keeps its meaning stable afterwards.

Meghna and Sons (illustrative). A local printer supplies 200-page exercise books to the shop at a wholesale price. Weekly quantity offered, 9 March 2026: Tk 40, 150 books; Tk 45, 200; Tk 50, 250; Tk 55, 300; Tk 60, 350. Elasticity from Tk 50 to Tk 55: +10 per cent price, +20 per cent quantity, elasticity 2.0 (elastic). Shift: on 1 April 2026 the printer's paper cost rose and it offered 50 fewer books at every price: 100, 150, 200, 250, 300. Exceptional curve 1: a rare first edition, only one copy exists, supply unchanged at any price. Exceptional curve 2: a part-time binder offers 20 hours a week at Tk 150 an hour, 26 hours at Tk 200, 24 hours at Tk 260. The case is illustrative, so it is used to show how the method works rather than to suggest facts beyond the record. Dates, amounts and decisions are treated as given data. When a conclusion depends on a condition, that condition is stated. When the case does not supply evidence for a claim, the discussion stays at the general level instead of creating a new fact.

* * *

7.1 | THE LAW OF SUPPLY | DEFINING THEORY | 550

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Supply** means the quantity of a good sellers are willing and able to offer at each possible price, in a given period. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). A local printer supplies 200-page exercise books to the shop at a wholesale price. Weekly quantity offered, 9 March 2026: Tk 40, 150 books; Tk 45, 200; Tk 50, 250; Tk 55, 300. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in the law of supply, before moving to the next step.

The term **Quantity supplied** means the amount sellers plan to offer at one particular price. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). A local printer supplies 200-page exercise books to the shop at a wholesale price. Weekly quantity offered, 9 March 2026: Tk 40, 150 books; Tk 45, 200; Tk 50, 250; Tk 55, 300. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader

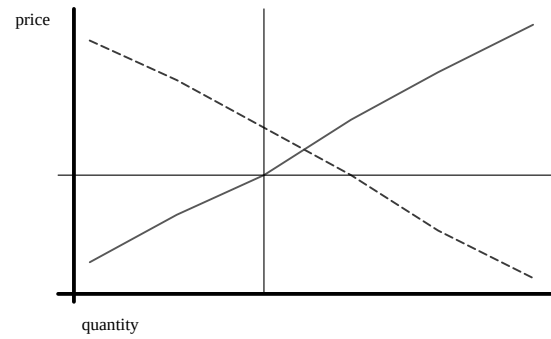


FIG. 5.1. a steep and a flat demand curve side by side for the same price change

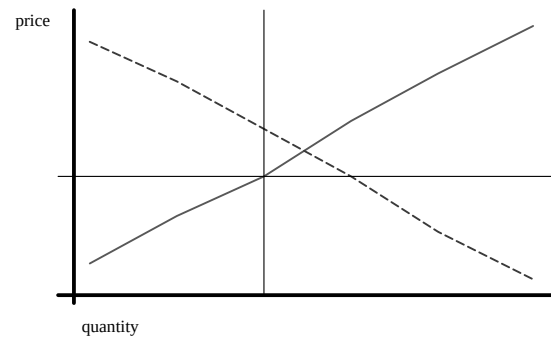


FIG. 5.2. five demand curves for the five forms of price elasticity

Reasoning. Begin by listing the given figures and identifying the relationship that the chapter explains. Where arithmetic is needed, write the starting figures first, then the change, then the result. Where the issue is descriptive, name the category and give the condition that places the case in that category. This keeps the method reproducible: another reader should be able to follow the same sequence and reach the same conclusion from the stated record.

Conclusion. The record illustrates the chapter's central relationship in a controlled setting. It does not prove that the same result must occur in every market, firm or household. The value of the worked case is that it shows how a general idea is applied while the assumptions remain visible.

Check. Re-read the quantities, prices, costs or inputs used in the calculation. Confirm that units and periods match and that no figure has been silently changed. If the result contradicts a stated fact, return to the earlier step rather than adjusting the conclusion to fit the expected answer.

* * *

SUMMARY

Teach how to measure how strongly buyers respond, with percentages, and what the answer means for revenue. The key terms now have fixed meanings, the running case has shown their use, and the limits of the rules have been kept visible. The next chapter can therefore treat these ideas as working tools rather than introduce them again from the beginning.

THINK IT THROUGH

5.T1 compute three elasticities from new price-quantity pairs and name each form, say which goods have low elasticity and why, compute income and cross elasticity from new data

5.T2 a seller wants more revenue — decide from the elasticity whether to cut or raise the price

WHERE PEOPLE GO WRONG

Correction. State the condition first. Then decide whether the new situation still satisfies it. If it does, the rule can be applied again; if it does not, the analysis must be adjusted.

Correction. A number becomes useful only after its unit, period and economic meaning are identified. Always say what the result measures and which figures produced it.

IN HISTORY

The entry directs attention to Alfred Marshall introduces elasticity of demand in Principles of Economics, 1890; search: Marshall Principles of Economics 1890 elasticity of demand origin. This account is used only for the historical connection specified by the chapter. It illustrates why the economic problem mattered in practice, while the chapter's analytical rules remain separate from the historical narrative.

The reasoning follows the data rather than an invented story.

The conclusion is limited to what the case supports.

A final check asks whether the result fits the original data.

The chapter has built one connected chain of reasoning.

A common error is to apply a rule after its condition has changed.

Another error is to confuse a numerical result with the meaning of that result.

The historical case shows the chapter idea in a documented setting.

The same method remains useful when the surrounding details change.

The same method remains useful when the surrounding details change.

The worked case applies the chapter without adding facts to the record.

The reasoning follows the data rather than an invented story.

The conclusion is limited to what the case supports.

A final check asks whether the result fits the original data.

rather than carried over unchanged. This disciplined sequence is the main practical skill developed by the chapter.

The reader should separate the starting condition from the change being examined, then identify the quantity that responds. This prevents a movement from being confused with a shift, a total from being confused with a marginal amount, or a descriptive fact from being confused with a judgement. The running case provides fixed figures, but the reasoning is broader: identify the relevant definition, state the condition, apply the relationship, and check the result against the original data. If one condition changes, the analysis must be repeated rather than carried over unchanged. This disciplined sequence is the main practical skill developed by the chapter.

The reader should separate the starting condition from the change being examined, then identify the quantity that responds. This prevents a movement from being confused with a shift, a total from being confused with a marginal amount, or a descriptive fact from being confused with a judgement. The running case provides fixed figures, but the reasoning is broader: identify the relevant definition, state the condition, apply the relationship, and check the result against the original data. If one condition changes, the analysis must be repeated rather than carried over unchanged. This disciplined sequence is the main practical skill developed by the chapter.

WORKED CASE: THE RUNNING RECORD

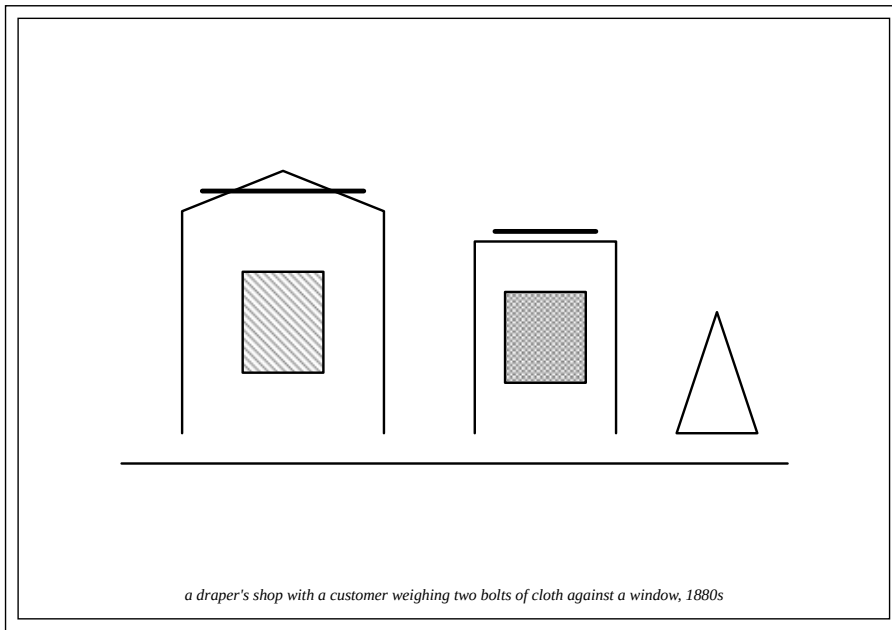
Situation. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Consumer surplus: on 14 March 2026 five customers' highest prices for a dictionary were Tk 900, Tk 800, Tk 700, Tk 650 and Tk 600; shelf price Tk 650; four buy and one does not. Surpluses: Tk 250, Tk 150, Tk 50, Tk 0, total Tk 450. Choice: a student's monthly spending plan is Tk 1,200 on prescribed books at Tk 150 each and stationery packs at Tk 100 each. Budget line bundles (books, packs): (0, 12), (2, 9), (4, 6), (6, 3), (8, 0). One indifference curve through (4, 6) also passes through (3, 8) and (6, 4); the slope between (3, 8) and (4, 6) is 2 packs per book, between (4, 6) and (6, 4) it is 1 pack per book. Best bundle: (4, 6), cost Tk 600 plus Tk 600 equals Tk 1,200; the price ratio 150 to 100 equals 1.5 packs per book. Question. What does the record show when the chapter's central rule is applied to these facts?

Reasoning. Begin by listing the given figures and identifying the relationship that the chapter explains. Where arithmetic is needed, write the starting figures first, then the change, then the result. Where the issue is descriptive, name the category and give the condition that places the case in that category. This keeps the method reproducible: another reader should be able to follow the same sequence and reach the same conclusion from the stated record.

Conclusion. The record illustrates the chapter's central relationship in a controlled setting. It does not prove that the same result must occur in every market, firm or household. The value of the worked case is that it shows how a general idea is applied while the assumptions remain visible.

Check. Re-read the quantities, prices, costs or inputs used in the calculation. Confirm that units and periods match and that no figure has been silently changed. If the result contradicts a stated fact, return to the earlier step rather than adjusting the conclusion to fit the expected answer.

* * *



CHAPTER VI

Consumer Choice: Surplus and Indifference Curves

What does this chapter let us explain that the earlier ideas could not explain alone?



Show what a buyer gains from a purchase and how a buyer with a fixed budget picks the best bundle. The chapter builds the idea in small stages, then applies it to the running case. The examples keep the stated conditions visible so the reasoning can be checked.

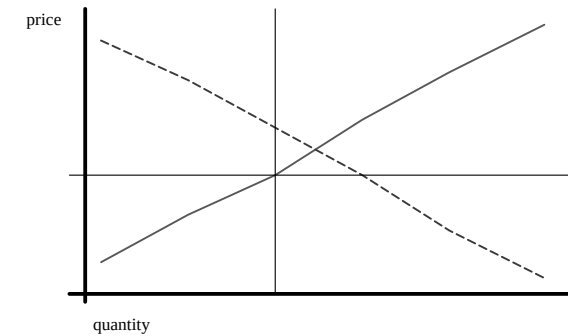


FIG. 6.2. a family of indifference curves, convex to the origin

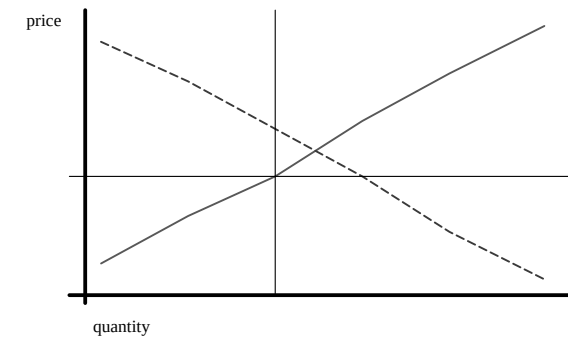


FIG. 6.3. a budget line drawn from a spending plan of Tk 1,200

The term **Willingness to pay** means the highest price a buyer would accept to get one unit of a good. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Consumer surplus: on 14 March 2026 five customers' highest prices for a dictionary were Tk 900, Tk 800, Tk 700, Tk 650 and Tk 600; shelf price Tk 650. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in consumption and consumer surplus, before moving to the next step.

The term **Consumer surplus** means the gap between what a buyer would pay and what is actually paid. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Consumer surplus: on 14 March 2026 five customers' highest prices for a dictionary were Tk 900, Tk 800, Tk 700, Tk 650 and Tk 600; shelf price Tk 650. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in consumption and consumer surplus, before moving to the next step.

A beginner can read this idea in two stages. First, ask what changes and what stays unchanged. Next, ask what the change does to the quantity, cost, price, satisfaction or output under discussion. The distinction is small in wording but large in analysis, because the same numerical change can have different meanings when the underlying condition is different.

The running case gives the idea a concrete setting without requiring a story or invented motives. The records identify dates, quantities and prices, so the reader can reproduce the reasoning. Where the case gives a number, the number is retained; where it gives a general rule, the explanation remains general rather than creating an unsupported shop record.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in consumption and consumer surplus to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

6.2 | INDIFFERENCE CURVES AND THE BUDGET LINE | FRAMEWORK | 775

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Indifference curve** means a line joining bundles of two goods that give a consumer the same satisfaction. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Consumer surplus: on 14 March 2026 five customers' highest prices for a dictionary were Tk 900, Tk 800, Tk 700, Tk 650 and Tk 600; shelf price Tk 650. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in indifference curves and the budget line, before moving to the next step.

Willingness to pay. the highest price a buyer would accept to get one unit of a good

Willingness to pay is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Consumer surplus. the gap between what a buyer would pay and what is actually paid

Consumer surplus is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Consumption and Consumer Surplus is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Consumption and Consumer Surplus is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

This section asks what indifference curves and the budget line means before applying it.

Indifference curve. a line joining bundles of two goods that give a consumer the same satisfaction

Indifference curve is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Indifference map. a set of indifference curves, with curves farther from the origin showing more satisfaction

Indifference map is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Marginal rate of substitution. the amount of one good a consumer will give up to gain one more unit of the other

Marginal rate of substitution is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Indifference Curves and the Budget Line is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Indifference Curves and the Budget Line is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Indifference Curves and the Budget Line is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

This section asks what consumer equilibrium means before applying it.

Budget line. a line showing every bundle of two goods a consumer can exactly afford with a given income

Budget line is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

The term **Indifference map** means a set of indifference curves, with curves farther from the origin showing more satisfaction. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Consumer surplus: on 14 March 2026 five customers' highest prices for a dictionary were Tk 900, Tk 800, Tk 700, Tk 650 and Tk 600; shelf price Tk 650. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in indifference curves and the budget line, before moving to the next step.

The term **Marginal rate of substitution** means the amount of one good a consumer will give up to gain one more unit of the other. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Consumer surplus: on 14 March 2026 five customers' highest prices for a dictionary were Tk 900, Tk 800, Tk 700, Tk 650 and Tk 600; shelf price Tk 650. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in indifference curves and the budget line, before moving to the next step.

The running case gives the idea a concrete setting without requiring a story or invented motives. The records identify dates, quantities and prices, so the reader can reproduce the reasoning. Where the case gives a number, the number is retained; where it gives a general rule, the explanation remains general rather than creating an unsupported shop record.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

There is also a limit to the rule. Economic relationships describe tendencies under stated conditions, not mechanical laws that ignore every other fact. If a condition changes, the result may change as well. A careful reader therefore states the condition before applying the rule and checks whether the new situation still satisfies it.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in indifference curves and the budget line to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

6.3 | CONSUMER EQUILIBRIUM | TECHNIQUE | 650

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Budget line** means a line showing every bundle of two goods a consumer can exactly afford with a given income. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Consumer surplus: on 14 March 2026 five customers' highest prices for a dictionary were Tk 900, Tk 800, Tk 700, Tk

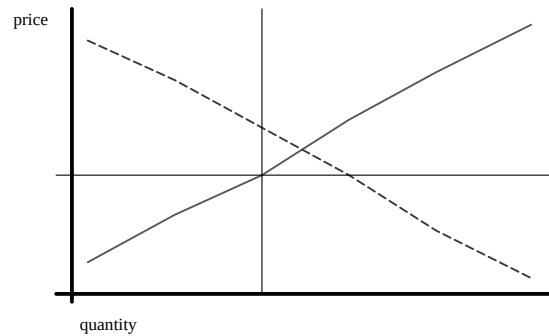


FIG. 7.3. a supply curve of labour that bends backward at high pay

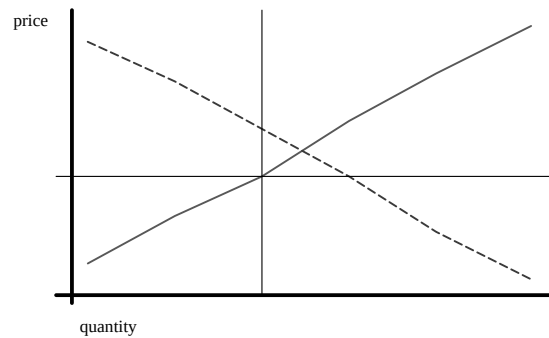


FIG. 7.4. three supply curves of different elasticity through the same point

The reader should separate the starting condition from the change being examined, then identify the quantity that responds. This prevents a movement from being confused with a shift, a total from being confused with a marginal amount, or a descriptive fact from being confused with a judgement. The running case provides fixed figures, but the reasoning is broader: identify the relevant definition, state the condition, apply the relationship, and check the result against the original data. If one condition changes, the analysis must be repeated rather than carried over unchanged. This disciplined sequence is the main practical skill developed by the chapter.

The reader should separate the starting condition from the change being examined, then identify the quantity that responds. This prevents a movement from being confused with a shift, a total from being confused with a marginal amount, or a descriptive fact from being confused with a judgement. The running case provides fixed figures, but the reasoning is broader: identify the relevant definition, state the condition, apply the relationship, and check the result against the original data. If one condition changes, the analysis must be repeated

The same method remains useful when the surrounding details change.

The same method remains useful when the surrounding details change.

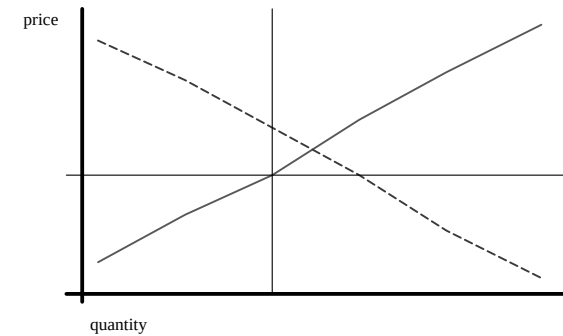


FIG. 9.2. average and marginal product on one diagram showing where they meet

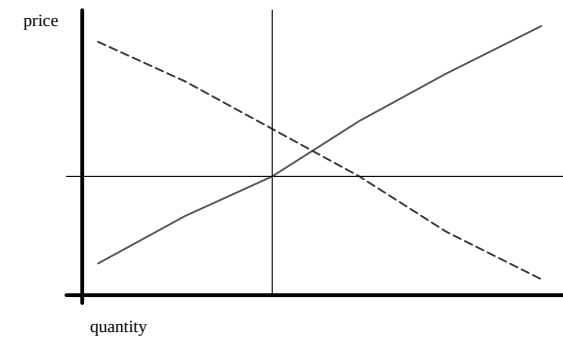


FIG. 9.3. a time bar marking the short run and the long run

THINK IT THROUGH

7.T1 draw a supply curve from a new schedule, separate five events into movements and shifts, compute and name three elasticities of supply from new data

7.T2 explain why a farmer's supply of a perishable crop is inelastic in the short run

WHERE PEOPLE GO WRONG

Correction. State the condition first. Then decide whether the new situation still satisfies it. If it does, the rule can be applied again; if it does not, the analysis must be adjusted.

Correction. A number becomes useful only after its unit, period and economic meaning are identified. Always say what the result measures and which figures produced it.

IN HISTORY

The entry directs attention to The Lancashire cotton famine of 1861 to 1865 and the rise of cotton exports from Egypt and India; search: Lancashire cotton famine 1861 Egypt India cotton exports. This account is used only for the historical connection specified by the chapter. It illustrates why the economic problem mattered in practice, while the chapter's analytical rules remain separate from the historical narrative.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

7.3 draw a supply curve from a new schedule, separate five events into movements and shifts, compute and name three elasticities of supply from new data

7.4 explain why a farmer's supply of a perishable crop is inelastic in the short run

7.5 after the shift passage and after the elasticity-of-supply formula

PAUSE AND CHECK 7.P6 after the shift passage

PAUSE AND CHECK 7.P7 the elasticity-of-supply formula

A common error is to apply a rule after its condition has changed.

Another error is to confuse a numerical result with the meaning of that result.

The historical case shows the chapter idea in a documented setting.

Diminishing Returns is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Diminishing Returns is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

This section asks what returns to scale means before applying it.

Returns to scale. the change in output when all inputs are changed by the same proportion

Returns to scale is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Increasing returns to scale. output rises by a larger proportion than inputs

Increasing returns to scale is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Constant returns to scale. output rises by the same proportion as inputs

Constant returns to scale is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

There is also a limit to the rule. Economic relationships describe tendencies under stated conditions, not mechanical laws that ignore every other fact. If a condition changes, the result may change as well. A careful reader therefore states the condition before applying the rule and checks whether the new situation still satisfies it.

The central question in diminishing returns is how a decision follows from limited information and a stated rule. A useful first step is to name the objects being compared, then keep the conditions fixed while one relationship is examined. This prevents several different causes from being mixed together. The result is a description that can be checked against the figures or the stated situation.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in diminishing returns to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

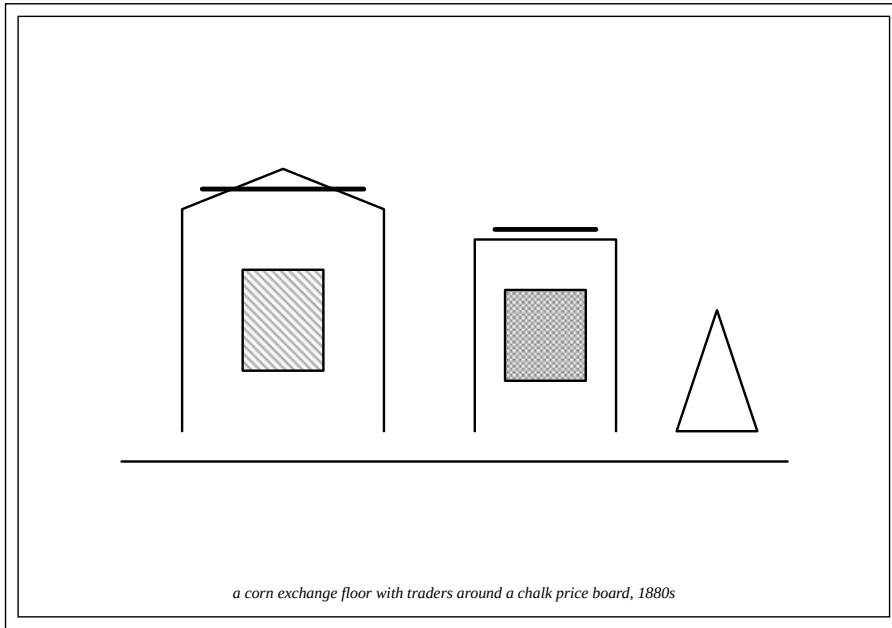
9.4 | RETURNS TO SCALE | TECHNIQUE | 450

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Returns to scale** means the change in output when all inputs are changed by the same proportion. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). On 3 March 2026 the shop opened a binding corner for theses with one binding machine. Short run, one machine and 1 to 6 workers, binds a day: 10, 24, 36, 44, 48, 48. Marginal product: 10, 14, 12, 8, 4, 0. Average product: 10, 12. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in returns to scale, before moving to the next step.

The term **Increasing returns to scale** means output rises by a larger proportion than inputs. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). On 3 March 2026 the shop opened a binding corner for theses with one binding machine. Short run, one machine and 1 to 6 workers, binds a day: 10, 24, 36, 44, 48, 48. Marginal product: 10, 14, 12, 8, 4, 0. Average product: 10, 12. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in returns to scale, before moving to the next step.

The term **Constant returns to scale** means output rises by the same proportion as inputs. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). On 3 March 2026 the shop opened a binding corner for theses with one binding machine. Short run, one machine and 1 to 6 workers, binds a day: 10, 24, 36, 44, 48, 48. Marginal product: 10, 14, 12, 8, 4, 0. Average product: 10, 12. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in returns to scale, before moving to the next step.



CHAPTER VIII

How Markets Find a Price

What does this chapter let us explain that the earlier ideas could not explain alone?



Bring demand and supply together to find a price, show why a market is pulled toward it, and measure who gains. The chapter builds the idea in small stages, then applies it to the running case. The examples keep the stated conditions visible so the reasoning can be checked.

Short run. a period too short to change at least one input, such as machines or floor space

Short run is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Long run. a period long enough to change every input

Long run is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Fixed input. an input whose quantity cannot be changed in the short run

Fixed input is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Variable input. an input whose quantity can be changed even in the short run

Variable input is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Short Run and Long Run is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Short Run and Long Run is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

The term **Short run** means a period too short to change at least one input, such as machines or floor space. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). On 3 March 2026 the shop opened a binding corner for theses with one binding machine. Short run, one machine and 1 to 6 workers, binds a day: 10, 24, 36, 44, 48, 48. Marginal product: 10, 14, 12, 8, 4, 0. Average product: 10, 12. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in short run and long run, before moving to the next step.

The term **Long run** means a period long enough to change every input. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). On 3 March 2026 the shop opened a binding corner for theses with one binding machine. Short run, one machine and 1 to 6 workers, binds a day: 10, 24, 36, 44, 48, 48. Marginal product: 10, 14, 12, 8, 4, 0. Average product: 10, 12. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in short run and long run, before moving to the next step.

The term **Fixed input** means an input whose quantity cannot be changed in the short run. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). On 3 March 2026 the shop opened a binding corner for theses with one binding machine. Short run, one machine and 1 to 6 workers, binds a day: 10, 24, 36, 44, 48, 48. Marginal product: 10, 14, 12, 8, 4, 0. Average product: 10, 12. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in short run and long run, before moving to the next step.

The term **Variable input** means an input whose quantity can be changed even in the short run. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). On 3 March 2026 the shop opened a binding corner for theses with one binding machine. Short run, one machine and 1 to 6 workers, binds a day: 10, 24, 36, 44, 48, 48. Marginal product: 10, 14, 12, 8, 4, 0. Average product: 10, 12. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in short run and long run, before moving to the next step.

The running case gives the idea a concrete setting without requiring a story or invented motives. The records identify dates, quantities and prices, so the reader can reproduce the reasoning. Where the case gives a number, the number is retained; where it gives a general rule, the explanation remains general rather than creating an unsupported shop record.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in short run and long run to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

The term **Equilibrium price** means the price at which quantity demanded equals quantity supplied. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Neighbourhood market for 200-page exercise books, weekly: demand $Q_d = 1,800 - 15P$ and supply $Q_s = 25P - 600$, with P in taka. Equilibrium: $P = Tk\ 60$, $Q = 900$. Ceiling at Tk 50: $Q_d\ 1,050$, $Q_s\ 650$, excess demand 400. Floor at Tk 70: In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in markets and market equilibrium, before moving to the next step.

The term **Equilibrium quantity** means the quantity bought and sold at the equilibrium price. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Neighbourhood market for 200-page exercise books, weekly: demand $Q_d = 1,800 - 15P$ and supply $Q_s = 25P - 600$, with P in taka. Equilibrium: $P = Tk\ 60$, $Q = 900$. Ceiling at Tk 50: $Q_d\ 1,050$, $Q_s\ 650$, excess demand 400. Floor at Tk 70: In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in markets and market equilibrium, before moving to the next step.

A beginner can read this idea in two stages. First, ask what changes and what stays unchanged. Next, ask what the change does to the quantity, cost, price, satisfaction or output under discussion. The distinction is small in wording but large in analysis, because the same numerical change can have different meanings when the underlying condition is different.

The running case gives the idea a concrete setting without requiring a story or invented motives. The records identify dates, quantities and prices, so the reader can reproduce the reasoning. Where the case gives a number, the number is retained; where it gives a general rule, the explanation remains general rather than creating an unsupported shop record.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in markets and market equilibrium to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

8.2 | FORCES TOWARD EQUILIBRIUM | NEW IDEA | 550

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Excess demand** means the amount by which quantity demanded exceeds quantity supplied at a price below equilibrium. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Neighbourhood market for 200-page exercise books, weekly: demand $Q_d = 1,800 - 15P$ and supply $Q_s = 25P - 600$, with P in taka. Equilibrium: $P = Tk\ 60$, $Q = 900$. Ceiling at Tk 50: $Q_d\ 1,050$, $Q_s\ 650$, excess demand 400. Floor at Tk 70: In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being

Equilibrium price. the price at which quantity demanded equals quantity supplied

Equilibrium price is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Equilibrium quantity. the quantity bought and sold at the equilibrium price

Equilibrium quantity is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Markets and Market Equilibrium is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Markets and Market Equilibrium is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

This section asks what forces toward equilibrium means before applying it.

Excess demand. the amount by which quantity demanded exceeds quantity supplied at a price below equilibrium

Excess demand is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

The opening question sets up the problem before the rule is named.

The reader first separates the objects of the analysis.

The running case provides records rather than invented narrative.

This section asks what the production function means before applying it.

Production. the process of turning resources into goods and services

Production is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Input. a resource used in production

Input is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Suppose you have to make a decision with a limited amount of money, time, space or equipment. Two choices may both be sensible, yet the same resources cannot serve both at once. The economic question is not whether one choice sounds attractive in isolation. It is what follows when the available resource is limited and a choice must be made. Explain how inputs become output, why adding one input yields less and less, and what changes when all inputs grow. This chapter develops that reasoning from a concrete setting to a general rule, then returns to the case so the rule can be checked.

Ask what is being chosen, who is making the choice, which quantity is being measured, and which conditions are being held fixed. This order prevents a common mistake: answering a different question from the one the evidence can answer. A price, a quantity, a cost, an input or a payment may appear in the same record, but each has a distinct role. The chapter therefore introduces each working term at its first necessary point and keeps its meaning stable afterwards.

Meghna and Sons (illustrative). On 3 March 2026 the shop opened a binding corner for theses with one binding machine. Short run, one machine and 1 to 6 workers, binds a day: 10, 24, 36, 44, 48, 48. Marginal product: 10, 14, 12, 8, 4, 0. Average product: 10, 12, 12, 11, 9.6, 8. Long run, scale tables (binds a day): one machine and 2 workers, 40; two machines and 4 workers, 90; four machines and 8 workers, 180; eight machines and 16 workers, 300. Types: first doubling gives 2.25 times output (increasing), second doubling gives 2.0 times (constant), third gives about 1.67 times (decreasing). The case is illustrative, so it is used to show how the method works rather than to suggest facts beyond the record. Dates, amounts and decisions are treated as given data. When a conclusion depends on a condition, that condition is stated. When the case does not supply evidence for a claim, the discussion stays at the general level instead of creating a new fact.

* * *

9.1 | THE PRODUCTION FUNCTION | NEW IDEA | 650

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Production** means the process of turning resources into goods and services. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). On 3 March 2026 the shop opened a binding corner for theses with one binding machine. Short run, one machine and 1 to 6 workers, binds a day: 10, 24, 36, 44, 48, 48. Marginal product: 10, 14, 12, 8, 4, 0. Average product: 10, 12. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in the production function, before moving to the next step.

The term **Input** means a resource used in production. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). On 3 March 2026 the shop opened a binding corner for theses with one binding machine. Short run, one machine and 1 to 6 workers, binds a day: 10, 24, 36, 44, 48, 48. Marginal product: 10, 14,

70: In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in shifts and new equilibria, before moving to the next step.

The term **Producer surplus** means the gap between the price a seller receives and the lowest price the seller would accept. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Neighbourhood market for 200-page exercise books, weekly: demand $Q_d = 1,800 - 15P$ and supply $Q_s = 25P - 600$, with P in taka. Equilibrium: $P = \text{Tk } 60$, $Q = 900$. Ceiling at Tk 50: Q_d 1,050, Q_s 650, excess demand 400. Floor at Tk 70: In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in shifts and new equilibria, before moving to the next step.

The term **Total surplus** means consumer surplus plus producer surplus, a measure of the gain from trade. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Neighbourhood market for 200-page exercise books, weekly: demand $Q_d = 1,800 - 15P$ and supply $Q_s = 25P - 600$, with P in taka. Equilibrium: $P = \text{Tk } 60$, $Q = 900$. Ceiling at Tk 50: Q_d 1,050, Q_s 650, excess demand 400. Floor at Tk 70: In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in shifts and new equilibria, before moving to the next step.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

There is also a limit to the rule. Economic relationships describe tendencies under stated conditions, not mechanical laws that ignore every other fact. If a condition changes, the result may change as well. A careful reader therefore states the condition before applying the rule and checks whether the new situation still satisfies it.

The central question in shifts and new equilibria is how a decision follows from limited information and a stated rule. A useful first step is to name the objects being compared, then keep the conditions fixed while one relationship is examined. This prevents several different causes from being mixed together. The result is a description that can be checked against the figures or the stated situation.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in shifts and new equilibria to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

8.4 | CONSUMER AND PRODUCER SURPLUS IN PRACTICE | NEW IDEA | 450

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the

Producer surplus, the gap between the price a seller receives and the lowest price the seller would accept

Producer surplus is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Total surplus, consumer surplus plus producer surplus, a measure of the gain from trade

Total surplus is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Shifts and New Equilibria is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Shifts and New Equilibria is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Shifts and New Equilibria is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

This section asks what consumer and producer surplus in practice means before applying it.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

8.3 find equilibrium from new equations, describe the adjustment from a price above or below it, trace the effect of a shift

8.4 a government sets a price ceiling below equilibrium for a staple — describe who gains and who loses

8.5 after the equilibrium solution and after the shortage-and-surplus passage

PAUSE AND CHECK 8.P6 after the equilibrium solution

PAUSE AND CHECK 8.P7 the shortage-and-surplus passage

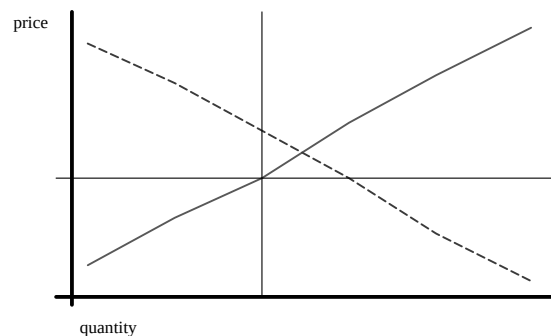


FIG. 8.2. a ceiling below and a floor above equilibrium with the shortage and surplus gaps marked

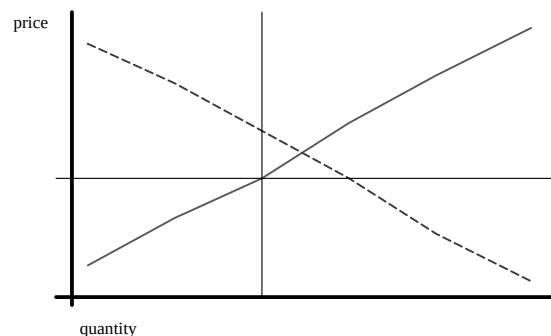


FIG. 8.3. two panels: a supply shift left and a demand shift right with the new equilibria

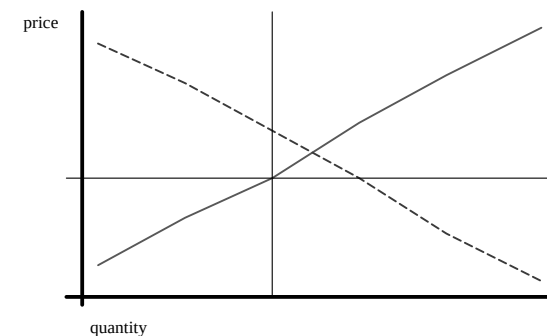


FIG. 8.4. consumer surplus and producer surplus shaded on one diagram

The same method remains useful when the surrounding details change.

The same method remains useful when the surrounding details change.

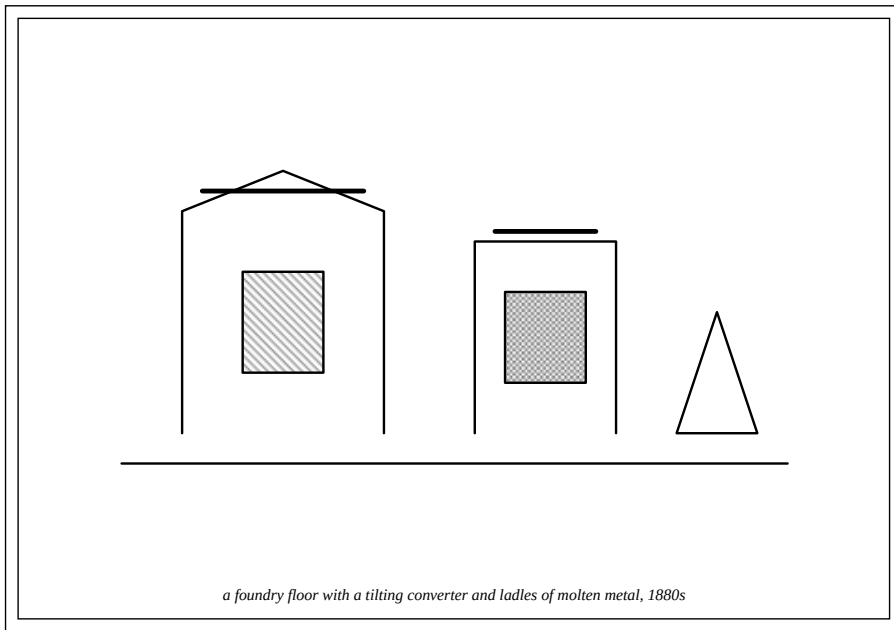
The reader should separate the starting condition from the change being examined, then identify the quantity that responds. This prevents a movement from being confused with a shift, a total from being confused with a marginal amount, or a descriptive fact from being confused with a judgement. The running case provides fixed figures, but the reasoning is broader: identify the relevant definition, state the condition, apply the relationship, and check the result against the original data. If one condition changes, the analysis must be repeated rather than carried over unchanged. This disciplined sequence is the main practical skill developed by the chapter.

The reader should separate the starting condition from the change being examined, then identify the quantity that responds. This prevents a movement from being confused with a shift, a total from being confused with a marginal amount, or a descriptive fact from being confused with a judgement. The running case provides fixed figures, but the reasoning is broader: identify the relevant definition, state the condition, apply the relationship, and check the result against the original data. If one condition changes, the analysis must be repeated rather than carried over unchanged. This disciplined sequence is the main practical skill developed by the chapter.

WORKED CASE: THE RUNNING RECORD

The worked case applies the chapter without adding facts to the record.

Situation. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Neighbourhood market for 200-page exercise books, weekly: demand $Q_d = 1,800 - 15P$ and supply $Q_s = 25P - 600$, with P in taka. Equilibrium: $P = \text{Tk } 60$, $Q = 900$. Ceiling at Tk 50: $Q_d 1,050$, $Q_s 650$, excess demand 400. Floor at Tk 70: $Q_d 750$, $Q_s 1,150$, excess supply 400. Supply shift: paper cost rises, supply becomes $Q_s = 25P - 760$; new equilibrium $P = \text{Tk } 64$, $Q = 840$. Demand intercept price is Tk 120; supply intercept price is Tk 24 before the shift. Consumer surplus at equilibrium: $0.5 \times (120 - 60) \times 900 = \text{Tk } 27,000$ a week; producer surplus: $0.5 \times (60 - 24) \times 900 = \text{Tk } 16,200$ a week. After the shift: consumer surplus $0.5 \times (120 - 64) \times 840 = \text{Tk } 23,520$; producer surplus $0.5 \times (64 - 30.4) \times 840 = \text{Tk } 14,112$. Substitute-goods link: when the price of petrol rises, demand for natural gas shifts right (kept as a general example, not shop data). Question. What does the record show when the chapter's central rule is applied to these facts?



CHAPTER X

Costs of Production

What does this chapter let us explain that the earlier ideas could not explain alone?



Show what costs a firm counts, how they change with output, and how to reach a given output at the lowest cost. The chapter builds the idea in small stages, then applies it to the running case. The examples keep the stated conditions visible so the reasoning can be checked.

what is being measured or compared in cost concepts, before moving to the next step.

The term **Explicit cost** means a cost paid out in money to others, such as rent or wages. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Binding corner monthly, 2026. Fixed cost Tk 20,000 (corner rent Tk 12,000 plus machine instalment Tk 8,000). Implicit cost: owners' unpaid time Tk 15,000 a month. Prime cost is materials and labour, equal to variable cost. Outpu. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in cost concepts, before moving to the next step.

The term **Implicit cost** means the value of resources the owner supplies, such as own time, for which no payment is made. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Binding corner monthly, 2026. Fixed cost Tk 20,000 (corner rent Tk 12,000 plus machine instalment Tk 8,000). Implicit cost: owners' unpaid time Tk 15,000 a month. Prime cost is materials and labour, equal to variable cost. Outpu. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in cost concepts, before moving to the next step.

The term **Fixed cost** means a cost that stays the same however much is produced in the short run. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Binding corner monthly, 2026. Fixed cost Tk 20,000 (corner rent Tk 12,000 plus machine instalment Tk 8,000). Implicit cost: owners' unpaid time Tk 15,000 a month. Prime cost is materials and labour, equal to variable cost. Outpu. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in cost concepts, before moving to the next step.

A beginner can read this idea in two stages. First, ask what changes and what stays unchanged. Next, ask what the change does to the quantity, cost, price, satisfaction or output under discussion. The distinction is small in wording but large in analysis, because the same numerical change can have different meanings when the underlying condition is different.

The running case gives the idea a concrete setting without requiring a story or invented motives. The records identify dates, quantities and prices, so the reader can reproduce the reasoning. Where the case gives a number, the number is retained; where it gives a general rule, the explanation remains general rather than creating an unsupported shop record.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in cost concepts to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

Explicit cost. a cost paid out in money to others, such as rent or wages

Explicit cost is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Implicit cost. the value of resources the owner supplies, such as own time, for which no payment is made

Implicit cost is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Fixed cost. a cost that stays the same however much is produced in the short run

Fixed cost is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Cost Concepts is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Cost Concepts is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Cost Concepts is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

nil. Pricing: price cut from Tk 60 to Tk 55 for the exercise book raised weekly sales from 200 to 210; revenue Tk 12,000 fell to Tk 11,550 (inelastic). Market structure ranking for the shop: exercise books near perfect competition; the sole-authorised reference work a monopoly; mystery novels monopolistic competition. Question. What does the record show when the chapter's central rule is applied to these facts?

Reasoning. Begin by listing the given figures and identifying the relationship that the chapter explains. Where arithmetic is needed, write the starting figures first, then the change, then the result. Where the issue is descriptive, name the category and give the condition that places the case in that category. This keeps the method reproducible: another reader should be able to follow the same sequence and reach the same conclusion from the stated record.

Conclusion. The record illustrates the chapter's central relationship in a controlled setting. It does not prove that the same result must occur in every market, firm or household. The value of the worked case is that it shows how a general idea is applied while the assumptions remain visible.

Check. Re-read the quantities, prices, costs or inputs used in the calculation. Confirm that units and periods match and that no figure has been silently changed. If the result contradicts a stated fact, return to the earlier step rather than adjusting the conclusion to fit the expected answer.

* * *

SUMMARY

Compare how firms behave when they face many rivals, one rival or none, and how each structure sets price and output. The key terms now have fixed meanings, the running case has shown their use, and the limits of the rules have been kept visible. The next chapter can therefore treat these ideas as working tools rather than introduce them again from the beginning.

THINK IT THROUGH

11.T1 find the profit-maximising output from a new cost table in each of three structures, name the structure from a list of features, decide whether a price cut helps revenue

11.T2 assess the view that firms always aim to maximise profit

WHERE PEOPLE GO WRONG

Correction. State the condition first. Then decide whether the new situation still satisfies it. If it does, the rule can be applied again; if it does not, the analysis must be adjusted.

Correction. A number becomes useful only after its unit, period and economic meaning are identified. Always say what the result measures and which figures produced it.

IN HISTORY

The entry directs attention to The 1911 US Supreme Court decision to break up Standard Oil; search: Standard Oil 1911 Supreme Court dissolution. This account is used only for the historical connection specified by the chapter. It

The reasoning follows the data rather than an invented story.

The conclusion is limited to what the case supports.

A final check asks whether the result fits the original data.

The chapter has built one connected chain of reasoning.

A common error is to apply a rule after its condition has changed.

Another error is to confuse a numerical result with the meaning of that result.

The historical case shows the chapter idea in a documented setting.

condition changes, the result may change as well. A careful reader therefore states the condition before applying the rule and checks whether the new situation still satisfies it.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in short-run cost curves to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

10.3 | LONG-RUN COST CURVES | NEW IDEA | 225

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Prime cost** means the direct cost of materials and labour that go into a unit of output. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Binding corner monthly, 2026. Fixed cost Tk 20,000 (corner rent Tk 12,000 plus machine instalment Tk 8,000). Implicit cost: owners' unpaid time Tk 15,000 a month. Prime cost is materials and labour, equal to variable cost. Output. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in long-run cost curves, before moving to the next step.

The term **Supplementary cost** means the cost of items apart from prime cost, such as rent and equipment, which remain even when output is nil. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Binding corner monthly, 2026. Fixed cost Tk 20,000 (corner rent Tk 12,000 plus machine instalment Tk 8,000). Implicit cost: owners' unpaid time Tk 15,000 a month. Prime cost is materials and labour, equal to variable cost. Output. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in long-run cost curves, before moving to the next step.

The term **Long-run average cost curve** means a curve showing the lowest average cost of each output when every input can be changed. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Binding corner monthly, 2026. Fixed cost Tk 20,000 (corner rent Tk 12,000 plus machine instalment Tk 8,000). Implicit cost: owners' unpaid time Tk 15,000 a month. Prime cost is materials and labour, equal to variable cost. Output. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in long-run cost curves, before moving to the next step.

The term **Isoquant** means a curve joining the input combinations that all make the same output. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Binding corner monthly, 2026. Fixed cost Tk 20,000 (corner rent Tk 12,000 plus machine instalment Tk 8,000). Implicit cost: owners' unpaid time Tk 15,000 a month. Prime cost is materials and labour, equal to variable cost.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

This section asks what long-run cost curves means before applying it.

Prime cost. the direct cost of materials and labour that go into a unit of output

Prime cost is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Supplementary cost. the cost of items apart from prime cost, such as rent and equipment, which remain even when output is nil

Supplementary cost is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Long-run average cost curve. a curve showing the lowest average cost of each output when every input can be changed

Long-run average cost curve is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Isoquant. a curve joining the input combinations that all make the same output

Isoquant is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

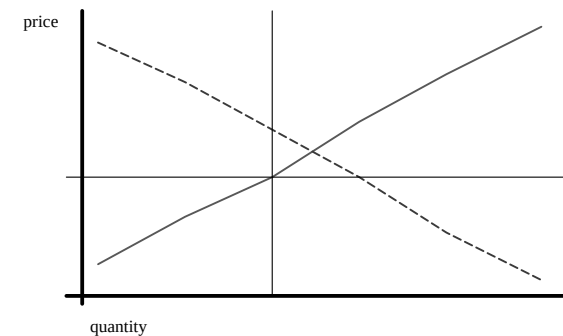


FIG. 11.2. a perfectly competitive firm at the point where marginal cost equals price, with industry beside it

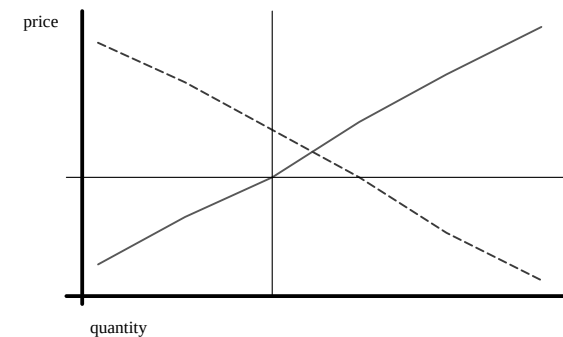


FIG. 11.3. a monopolist's demand and marginal revenue curves with the profit rectangle

The central question in least-cost combination is how a decision follows from limited information and a stated rule. A useful first step is to name the objects being compared, then keep the conditions fixed while one relationship is examined. This prevents several different causes from being mixed together. The result is a description that can be checked against the figures or the stated situation.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in least-cost combination to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

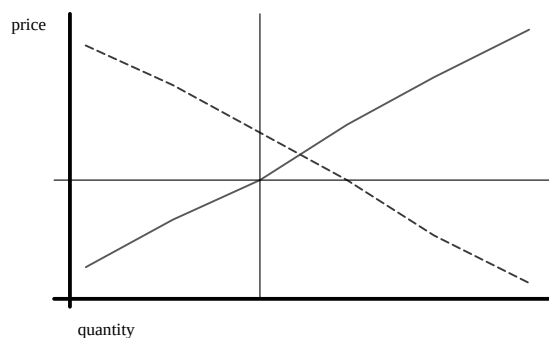


FIG. 10.1. fixed, variable and total cost curves on one diagram

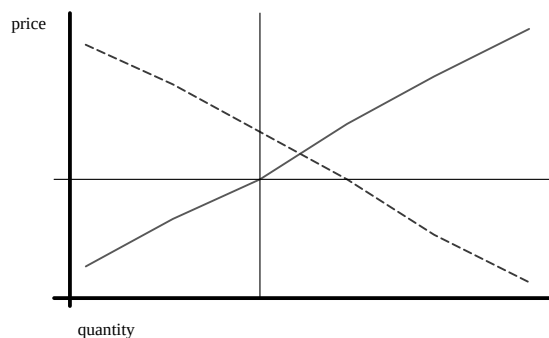


FIG. 10.2. average cost and marginal cost curves, with marginal cost cutting average cost at its lowest point

Least-Cost Combination is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

Bilateral monopoly. a market with a single seller facing a single buyer

Bilateral monopoly is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Monopolistic competition. a market with many sellers of similar but not identical goods and free entry

Monopolistic competition is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Monopolistic Competition is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Monopolistic Competition is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

The term **Bilateral monopoly** means a market with a single seller facing a single buyer. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Perfect competition: exercise books, market price Tk 60. Firm marginal cost by daily output: 10 books, Tk 40; 20, Tk 50; 30, Tk 60; 40, Tk 70. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in monopolistic competition, before moving to the next step.

The term **Monopolistic competition** means a market with many sellers of similar but not identical goods and free entry. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Perfect competition: exercise books, market price Tk 60. Firm marginal cost by daily output: 10 books, Tk 40; 20, Tk 50; 30, Tk 60; 40, Tk 70. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in monopolistic competition, before moving to the next step.

There is also a limit to the rule. Economic relationships describe tendencies under stated conditions, not mechanical laws that ignore every other fact. If a condition changes, the result may change as well. A careful reader therefore states the condition before applying the rule and checks whether the new situation still satisfies it.

The central question in monopolistic competition is how a decision follows from limited information and a stated rule. A useful first step is to name the objects being compared, then keep the conditions fixed while one relationship is examined. This prevents several different causes from being mixed together. The result is a description that can be checked against the figures or the stated situation.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in monopolistic competition to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

11.5 | PRICING AND THE FIRM'S GOAL | FRAMEWORK | 225

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Product differentiation** means making a firm's good different from rivals' in quality, design, brand or service. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Perfect competition: exercise books, market price Tk 60. Firm marginal cost by daily output: 10 books, Tk 40; 20, Tk 50; 30, Tk 60; 40, Tk 70. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in pricing and the firm's goal, before moving to the next step.

This section asks what pricing and the firm's goal means before applying it.

Product differentiation. making a firm's good different from rivals' in quality, design, brand or service

Product differentiation is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

workers and 8 machines Tk 14,400; 24 workers and 2 machines Tk 16,800; least cost Tk 12,000, where marginal product of labour is 30 and of a machine 60 (30 over 600 equals 60 over 1,200). Question. What does the record show when the chapter's central rule is applied to these facts?

Reasoning. Begin by listing the given figures and identifying the relationship that the chapter explains. Where arithmetic is needed, write the starting figures first, then the change, then the result. Where the issue is descriptive, name the category and give the condition that places the case in that category. This keeps the method reproducible: another reader should be able to follow the same sequence and reach the same conclusion from the stated record.

Conclusion. The record illustrates the chapter's central relationship in a controlled setting. It does not prove that the same result must occur in every market, firm or household. The value of the worked case is that it shows how a general idea is applied while the assumptions remain visible.

Check. Re-read the quantities, prices, costs or inputs used in the calculation. Confirm that units and periods match and that no figure has been silently changed. If the result contradicts a stated fact, return to the earlier step rather than adjusting the conclusion to fit the expected answer.

* * *

SUMMARY

Show what costs a firm counts, how they change with output, and how to reach a given output at the lowest cost. The key terms now have fixed meanings, the running case has shown their use, and the limits of the rules have been kept visible. The next chapter can therefore treat these ideas as working tools rather than introduce them again from the beginning.

THINK IT THROUGH

- 10.T1 complete the cost columns from new data, find where marginal cost crosses average cost, choose the cheapest input mix from three priced options
- 10.T2 explain why a family business should count its own unpaid time as a cost when judging success

WHERE PEOPLE GO WRONG

Correction. State the condition first. Then decide whether the new situation still satisfies it. If it does, the rule can be applied again; if it does not, the analysis must be adjusted.

Correction. A number becomes useful only after its unit, period and economic meaning are identified. Always say what the result measures and which figures produced it.

IN HISTORY

The entry directs attention to Henry Bessemer's converter process, 1856, and the fall in the price of steel; search: Bessemer process 1856 steel price fall per ton. This account is used only for the historical connection specified by the chapter. It illustrates why the economic problem mattered in practice, while the chapter's analytical rules remain separate from the historical narrative.

The reasoning follows the data rather than an invented story.

The conclusion is limited to what the case supports.

A final check asks whether the result fits the original data.

The chapter has built one connected chain of reasoning.

A common error is to apply a rule after its condition has changed.

Another error is to confuse a numerical result with the meaning of that result.

The historical case shows the chapter idea in a documented setting.

Price maker. a firm large enough that its own output choices affect the price

Price maker is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Marginal revenue. the extra revenue gained by selling one more unit

Marginal revenue is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Perfect Competition is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Perfect Competition is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Perfect Competition is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

This section asks what monopoly means before applying it.

Perfect competition. a market with many sellers, an identical product, free entry and full information, so each firm takes the price

Perfect competition is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

The term **Price maker** means a firm large enough that its own output choices affect the price. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Perfect competition: exercise books, market price Tk 60. Firm marginal cost by daily output: 10 books, Tk 40; 20, Tk 50; 30, Tk 60; 40, Tk 70. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in perfect competition, before moving to the next step.

The term **Marginal revenue** means the extra revenue gained by selling one more unit. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Perfect competition: exercise books, market price Tk 60. Firm marginal cost by daily output: 10 books, Tk 40; 20, Tk 50; 30, Tk 60; 40, Tk 70. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in perfect competition, before moving to the next step.

The running case gives the idea a concrete setting without requiring a story or invented motives. The records identify dates, quantities and prices, so the reader can reproduce the reasoning. Where the case gives a number, the number is retained; where it gives a general rule, the explanation remains general rather than creating an unsupported shop record.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

There is also a limit to the rule. Economic relationships describe tendencies under stated conditions, not mechanical laws that ignore every other fact. If a condition changes, the result may change as well. A careful reader therefore states the condition before applying the rule and checks whether the new situation still satisfies it.

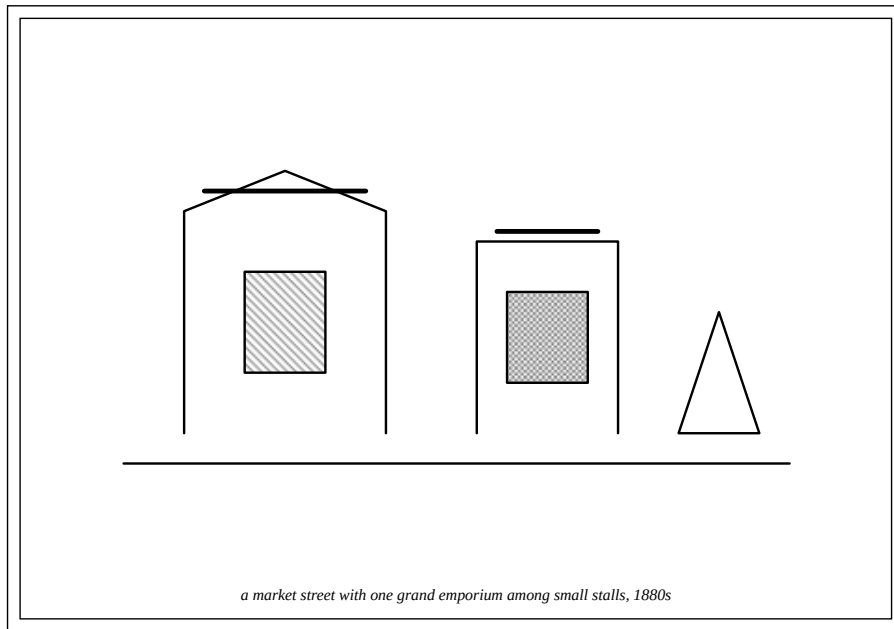
Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in perfect competition to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

11.3 | MONOPOLY | NEW IDEA | 550

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Perfect competition** means a market with many sellers, an identical product, free entry and full information, so each firm takes the price. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Perfect competition: exercise books, market price Tk 60. Firm marginal cost by daily output: 10 books, Tk 40; 20, Tk 50; 30, Tk 60; 40, Tk 70. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely



The opening question sets up the problem before the rule is named.

The reader first separates the objects of the analysis.

The running case provides records rather than invented narrative.

CHAPTER XI

Market Structures and the Firm

What does this chapter let us explain that the earlier ideas could not explain alone?



Compare how firms behave when they face many rivals, one rival or none, and how each structure sets price and output. The chapter builds the idea in small stages, then applies it to the running case.

The examples keep the stated conditions visible so the reasoning can be checked.

This section asks what types of market means before applying it.

Market structure. the features of a market, such as number of sellers, type of product and ease of entry, that shape how firms behave
Market structure is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Suppose you have to make a decision with a limited amount of money, time, space or equipment. Two choices may both be sensible, yet the same resources cannot serve both at once. The economic question is not whether one choice sounds attractive in isolation. It is what follows when the available resource is limited and a choice must be made. Compare how firms behave when they face many rivals, one rival or none, and how each structure sets price and output. This chapter develops that reasoning from a concrete setting to a general rule, then returns to the case so the rule can be checked.

Ask what is being chosen, who is making the choice, which quantity is being measured, and which conditions are being held fixed. This order prevents a common mistake: answering a different question from the one the evidence can answer. A price, a quantity, a cost, an input or a payment may appear in the same record, but each has a distinct role. The chapter therefore introduces each working term at its first necessary point and keeps its meaning stable afterwards.

Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Perfect competition: exercise books, market price Tk 60. Firm marginal cost by daily output: 10 books, Tk 40; 20, Tk 50; 30, Tk 60; 40, Tk 70; 50, Tk 80. Profit-maximising output 30 (marginal cost equals Tk 60). Average cost at 30 books Tk 52; profit $(60 - 52) \times 30 = \text{Tk } 240$ a day. Entry of new shops lowers price toward average cost in the long run. Monopoly: sole authorised seller of one foreign reference work. Price and weekly quantity: Tk 1,000, 10 copies; Tk 900, 20; Tk 800, 30; Tk 700, 40. Total revenue Tk 10,000; 18,000; 24,000; 28,000. Marginal revenue between steps Tk 800; 600; 400. Marginal cost constant Tk 500. Profit-maximising output 30 copies at Tk 800; profit $(800 - 500) \times 30 = \text{Tk } 9,000$. Monopolistic competition: a mystery novel series differentiated by cover and author; price Tk 400; short run average cost Tk 340 at 50 copies a week; profit Tk 3,000. After two more shops enter, the shop sells 40 copies at Tk 380 with average cost Tk 380; profit nil. Pricing: price cut from Tk 60 to Tk 55 for the exercise book raised weekly sales from 200 to 210; revenue Tk 12,000 fell to Tk 11,550 (inelastic). Market structure ranking for the shop: exercise books near perfect competition; the sole-authorised reference work a monopoly; mystery novels monopolistic competition. The case is illustrative, so it is used to show how the method works rather than to suggest facts beyond the record. Dates, amounts and decisions are treated as given data. When a conclusion depends on a condition, that condition is stated. When the case does not supply evidence for a claim, the discussion stays at the general level instead of creating a new fact.

* * *

11.1 | TYPES OF MARKET | FRAMEWORK | 225

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Market structure** means the features of a market, such as number of sellers, type of product and ease of entry, that shape how firms behave. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Perfect competition: exercise books, market price Tk 60. Firm marginal cost by daily output: 10

rent: main road Tk 150,000; side lane Tk 90,000; marginal plot Tk 60,000 (pays no rent). Differential rent: Tk 90,000; Tk 30,000. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in rent, before moving to the next step.

The term **Differential rent** means the extra return a better plot earns over the poorest plot in use. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Rent: three locations for a stall, yearly figures before rent: main road Tk 150,000; side lane Tk 90,000; marginal plot Tk 60,000 (pays no rent). Differential rent: Tk 90,000; Tk 30,000. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in rent, before moving to the next step.

The term **Wage** means the payment made to labour for its work. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Rent: three locations for a stall, yearly figures before rent: main road Tk 150,000; side lane Tk 90,000; marginal plot Tk 60,000 (pays no rent). Differential rent: Tk 90,000; Tk 30,000. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in rent, before moving to the next step.

A beginner can read this idea in two stages. First, ask what changes and what stays unchanged. Next, ask what the change does to the quantity, cost, price, satisfaction or output under discussion. The distinction is small in wording but large in analysis, because the same numerical change can have different meanings when the underlying condition is different.

The running case gives the idea a concrete setting without requiring a story or invented motives. The records identify dates, quantities and prices, so the reader can reproduce the reasoning. Where the case gives a number, the number is retained; where it gives a general rule, the explanation remains general rather than creating an unsupported shop record.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in rent to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

12.2 | WAGES | FRAMEWORK | 775

The section is organised around a question that can be answered from the definitions, the case record and the stated conditions. Start with the smallest version of the problem. Then add the detail that changes the result. This order makes the reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Nominal wage** means the wage counted in money. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Rent: three locations for a stall, yearly figures before rent: main road Tk 150,000; side lane Tk 90,000; marginal plot Tk 60,000 (pays no rent). Differential rent: Tk 90,000; Tk 30,000. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in wages, before moving to the next step.

Differential rent. the extra return a better plot earns over the poorest plot in use

Differential rent is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Wage. the payment made to labour for its work

Wage is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Rent is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Rent is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

This section asks what wages means before applying it.

Nominal wage. the wage counted in money

Nominal wage is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter III*)

Scarcity. the condition in which resources are too few to satisfy all the wants people have. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter I*)

Science. a body of knowledge built by observing facts, forming explanations and testing them. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter II*)

Service. an activity done for someone, such as binding a thesis or delivering parcels. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter I*)

Short run. a period too short to change at least one input, such as machines or floor space. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IX*)

Snob effect. a fall in demand for a good because more people begin to own it. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IV*)

Substitute goods. goods that can replace each other, so a rise in one's price raises demand for the other. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IV*)

Supplementary cost. the cost of items apart from prime cost, such as rent and equipment, which remain even when output is nil. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter X*)

Supply. the quantity of a good sellers are willing and able to offer at each possible price, in a given period. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VII*)

Supply curve. a line on a graph showing the quantity supplied at each price, other things equal. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VII*)

Supply schedule. a table listing the quantity supplied at each of several prices. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VII*)

Total cost. fixed cost plus variable cost at a given output. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter X*)

Total product. the whole output from a given amount of inputs. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IX*)

Total revenue. the money a seller receives from sales, found by price multiplied by quantity sold. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example

reasoning visible and reduces the temptation to memorise a formula without understanding what its parts represent.

The term **Profit** means the reward of enterprise: what remains of revenue after the other factors are paid. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Rent: three locations for a stall, yearly figures before rent: main road Tk 150,000; side lane Tk 90,000; marginal plot Tk 60,000 (pays no rent). Differential rent: Tk 90,000; Tk 30,000. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in interest, before moving to the next step.

The term **Economic profit** means revenue less all costs, explicit and implicit. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Rent: three locations for a stall, yearly figures before rent: main road Tk 150,000; side lane Tk 90,000; marginal plot Tk 60,000 (pays no rent). Differential rent: Tk 90,000; Tk 30,000. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in interest, before moving to the next step.

The term **Accounting profit** means revenue less explicit costs only. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Rent: three locations for a stall, yearly figures before rent: main road Tk 150,000; side lane Tk 90,000; marginal plot Tk 60,000 (pays no rent). Differential rent: Tk 90,000; Tk 30,000. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in interest, before moving to the next step.

The term **Normal profit** means the least profit that keeps a firm in business, equal to the implicit costs of the owner's own resources. For the running case, the record gives a concrete numerical or organisational setting in which this idea can be seen. Meghna and Sons (illustrative). Rent: three locations for a stall, yearly figures before rent: main road Tk 150,000; side lane Tk 90,000; marginal plot Tk 60,000 (pays no rent). Differential rent: Tk 90,000; Tk 30,000. In this chapter, the term matters because it lets the reader state precisely what is being measured or compared in interest, before moving to the next step.

The same reasoning can be transferred to another setting. A household, market stall, workshop or larger firm may have different numbers, but the analytical sequence remains: identify the decision, state the relevant condition, apply the rule, and inspect the result. This transfer is important because an economic idea is useful only when it can be recognised outside its first example.

There is also a limit to the rule. Economic relationships describe tendencies under stated conditions, not mechanical laws that ignore every other fact. If a condition changes, the result may change as well. A careful reader therefore states the condition before applying the rule and checks whether the new situation still satisfies it.

Before moving on, keep one question in view: what must remain true for the rule in interest to apply? The answer is contained in the definitions and examples above. If the condition changes, do not reuse the conclusion automatically. Re-state the problem, identify the new condition, and then apply the rule again.

* * *

Profit. the reward of enterprise: what remains of revenue after the other factors are paid

Profit is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Economic profit. revenue less all costs, explicit and implicit

Economic profit is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Accounting profit. revenue less explicit costs only

Accounting profit is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Normal profit. the least profit that keeps a firm in business, equal to the implicit costs of the owner's own resources

Normal profit is the working idea for this part of the chapter.

Interest is understood by separating the question into small steps.

Interest is understood by separating the question into small steps.

The section closes by restating the condition that controls the result.

Perfect competition. a market with many sellers, an identical product, free entry and full information, so each firm takes the price. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter XI*)

Perfectly elastic demand. demand that vanishes completely for any price rise, however small, shown as a flat curve. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter V*)

Perfectly inelastic demand. demand that does not change at all when price changes, shown as a vertical curve. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter V*)

Positive statement. a claim about what is, which can be checked against facts. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter II*)

Price ceiling. a legal maximum price that may be charged for a good. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VIII*)

Price elasticity of demand. the percentage change in quantity demanded divided by the percentage change in price. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter V*)

Price elasticity of supply. the percentage change in quantity supplied divided by the percentage change in price. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VII*)

Price floor. a legal minimum price that may be charged for a good. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VIII*)

Price maker. a firm large enough that its own output choices affect the price. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter XI*)

Price taker. a firm that must accept the market price because it is too small to change it. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter XI*)

Prime cost. the direct cost of materials and labour that go into a unit of output. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter X*)

Producer surplus. the gap between the price a seller receives and the lowest price the seller would accept. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VIII*)

Product differentiation. making a firm's good different from rivals' in quality, design, brand or service. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter XI*)

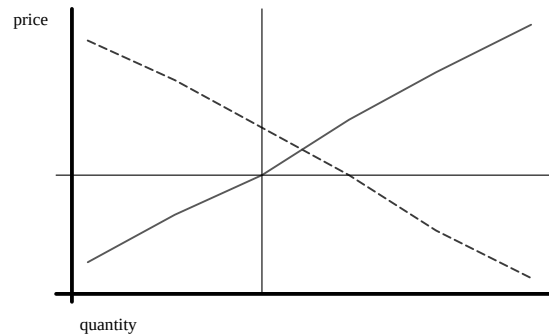


FIG. 12.1. differential rent on three plots of different yield

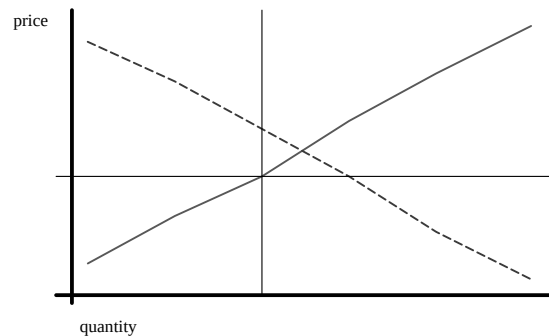


FIG. 12.2. a labour market with demand and supply setting the wage

definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VII*)

Least-cost combination. the mix of inputs that makes a given output for the lowest total cost. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter X*)

Long run. a period long enough to change every input. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IX*)

Long-run average cost curve. a curve showing the lowest average cost of each output when every input can be changed. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter X*)

Macroeconomics. the study of the economy as a whole, such as total output, jobs and the general price level. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter II*)

Marginal cost. the extra cost of producing one more unit. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter X*)

Marginal product. the extra output from adding one more unit of the variable input. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IX*)

Marginal productivity theory. the view that each factor is paid in line with the extra output its last unit adds. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter XII*)

Marginal rate of substitution. the amount of one good a consumer will give up to gain one more unit of the other. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VI*)

Marginal revenue. the extra revenue gained by selling one more unit. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter XI*)

Marginal utility. the extra satisfaction gained from consuming one more unit of a good. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter III*)

Market. any arrangement that brings buyers and sellers of a good together. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IV*)

Market demand. the sum of all individual buyers' demands for a good at each price. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IV*)

Market structure. the features of a market, such as number of sellers, type of product and ease of entry, that shape how firms behave. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter XI*)

first, then the change, then the result. Where the issue is descriptive, name the category and give the condition that places the case in that category. This keeps the method reproducible: another reader should be able to follow the same sequence and reach the same conclusion from the stated record.

Conclusion. The record illustrates the chapter's central relationship in a controlled setting. It does not prove that the same result must occur in every market, firm or household. The value of the worked case is that it shows how a general idea is applied while the assumptions remain visible.

Check. Re-read the quantities, prices, costs or inputs used in the calculation. Confirm that units and periods match and that no figure has been silently changed. If the result contradicts a stated fact, return to the earlier step rather than adjusting the conclusion to fit the expected answer.

* * *

SUMMARY

Explain how the money earned from production is shared among land, labour, capital and enterprise. The key terms now have fixed meanings, the running case has shown their use, and the limits of the rules have been kept visible. The next chapter can therefore treat these ideas as working tools rather than introduce them again from the beginning.

THINK IT THROUGH

12.T1 compute differential rents for new plots, compute a real wage from new price data, separate economic profit from accounting profit in a new account

12.T2 explain why the poorest plot in use earns no rent

WHERE PEOPLE GO WRONG

Correction. State the condition first. Then decide whether the new situation still satisfies it. If it does, the rule can be applied again; if it does not, the analysis must be adjusted.

Correction. A number becomes useful only after its unit, period and economic meaning are identified. Always say what the result measures and which figures produced it.

IN HISTORY

The entry directs attention to David Ricardo's rent theory in his 1815 essay and his 1817 Principles, and the Corn Laws repealed in 1846; search: Ricardo rent Corn Laws 1815 repeal 1846. This account is used only for the historical connection specified by the chapter. It illustrates why the economic problem mattered in practice, while the chapter's analytical rules remain separate from the historical narrative.

SOURCES

Further reading and historical attribution should be checked against the original works and reliable archival or institutional sources. The chapter does not require the reader to

The conclusion is limited to what the case supports.

A final check asks whether the result fits the original data.

The chapter has built one connected chain of reasoning.

A common error is to apply a rule after its condition has changed.

Another error is to confuse a numerical result with the meaning of that result.

The historical case shows the chapter idea in a documented setting.

The chapter uses a small number of historical references to anchor its defining ideas.

shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VIII*)

Excess supply. the amount by which quantity supplied exceeds quantity demanded at a price above equilibrium. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VIII*)

Explicit cost. a cost paid out in money to others, such as rent or wages. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter X*)

Factor of production. one of the four kinds of resource used in making things: land, labour, capital, enterprise. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter I*)

Factor price. the payment a factor of production earns: rent for land, wages for labour, interest for capital, profit for enterprise. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter XII*)

Firm. an organisation that uses resources to make goods or services and sell them. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter I*)

Fixed cost. a cost that stays the same however much is produced in the short run. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter X*)

Fixed input. an input whose quantity cannot be changed in the short run. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IX*)

Giffen good. a rare inferior good for which a price rise leads buyers to buy more of it. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IV*)

Good. a physical thing people buy to satisfy a want, such as a book or a pen. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter I*)

Household. a person or group living together that buys goods and services and supplies resources. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter I*)

Implicit cost. the value of resources the owner supplies, such as own time, for which no payment is made. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter X*)

Income elasticity of demand. the percentage change in quantity demanded divided by the percentage change in buyers' income. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter V*)

Increasing returns to scale. output rises by a larger proportion than inputs. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IX*)

APPENDIX A

Maths You Will Use



Constant returns to scale. output rises by the same proportion as inputs. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IX*)

Consumer. a person who buys or uses goods and services to meet wants. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter III*)

Consumer equilibrium. the affordable bundle that gives a consumer the greatest satisfaction. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VI*)

Consumer surplus. the gap between what a buyer would pay and what is actually paid. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VI*)

Consumption. the using up of goods and services to meet wants. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VI*)

Cost. the value of the resources used up in making a good or service. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter X*)

Cross elasticity of demand. the percentage change in quantity demanded of one good divided by the percentage change in another good's price. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter V*)

Decreasing returns to scale. output rises by a smaller proportion than inputs. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IX*)

Demand. the quantity of a good people are willing and able to buy at each possible price, in a given period. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IV*)

Demand curve. a line on a graph showing the quantity demanded at each price, other things equal. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IV*)

Demand schedule. a table listing the quantity demanded at each of several prices. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IV*)

Determinants of demand. the things other than the good's own price that change how much people want to buy. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter IV*)

Determinants of supply. the things other than the good's own price that change how much sellers offer. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example shows how the term works before it is applied to a changed situation. (*Chapter VII*)

Differential rent. the extra return a better plot earns over the poorest plot in use. The chapter uses this definition consistently; the running example

A.4 A1.4 | READING A GRAPH | TECHNIQUE | 250

In reading a graph, write the given numbers before choosing an operation. Keep the units visible, carry the arithmetic line by line, and round only at the point required by the question. For a percentage change, compare the change with the starting value. For an average, add the values and divide by their count. For an equation, perform the same operation on both sides. For a graph, read the axes before reading a point.

Given a price of Tk 60 rising to Tk 66, the change is Tk 6. The percentage change is $6 \div 60 \times 100 = 10$ per cent. The important check is that the starting value is 60, not 66. The same discipline applies to ratios, equations and graphs: identify the reference quantity before calculating.

Reading a graph is a tool for checking numerical relationships.

A tiny worked example makes the procedure concrete.

ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

CHAPTER 1 · SCARCITY, CHOICE AND THE ECONOMIC PROBLEM

1.t1 Apply the definition and conditions stated in the chapter. For a calculation, show the relevant change and divide or multiply only after identifying the correct starting value and unit.

1.t2 Apply the definition and conditions stated in the chapter. For a calculation, show the relevant change and divide or multiply only after identifying the correct starting value and unit.

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1.p7 Apply the definition and conditions stated in the chapter. For a calculation, show the relevant change and divide or multiply only after identifying the correct starting value and unit.

CHAPTER 11 · ECONOMIC REASONING, LAWS AND THE SCOPE OF MICROECONOMICS

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CHAPTER V · ELASTICITY OF DEMAND

5.t1 Apply the definition and conditions stated in the chapter. For a calculation, show the relevant change and divide or multiply only after identifying the correct starting value and unit.

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CHAPTER VI · CONSUMER CHOICE: SURPLUS AND INDIFFERENCE CURVES

6.t1 Apply the definition and conditions stated in the chapter. For a calculation, show the relevant change and divide or multiply only after identifying the correct starting value and unit.

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Product differentiation, 104

Production, 3, 80–81, 112, 116, 119

Production function, 80–81

Profit, 100, 105–109, 112, 115–116, 118–120

Profit maximisation, 105

Pure competition, 103

Pure monopoly, 103

Q

Quantity demanded, 31–32, 41, 44, 71–72

Quantity supplied, 60–62, 71–72

R

Rate of interest, 114, 118

Real wage, 112, 114, 118–120

Resource, 2–5, 12, 20, 30, 40, 50, 60, 70, 80, 90–91, ...

Returns to scale, 84–85, 88

Risk bearing, 116

S

Saturation point, 23

Scarcity, 2–4, 8–9

Science, 12–13

Service, 3–5, 20, 50, 80–81, 90, 104, 114

Short run, 67, 80–87, 91, 100, 107

Snob effect, 30, 34, 36

Substitute goods, 33

Supplementary cost, 93

Supply, 2, 12, 20, 30, 40, 50, 60–67, 70–77, 80, 90, ...

Supply curve, 61–62, 64–65, 67, 74

Supply schedule, 61

T

Total cost, 90, 92, 94–96, 105

Total product, 83, 85

Total revenue, 40, 43, 46, 100, 105, 107

Total surplus, 73

Total utility, 20–21, 23–24, 26

U

Unit elastic demand, 42

Util, 20–27, 57

Utility, 20–27, 57

V

Variable cost, 90–94, 96

CHAPTER IX · PRODUCTION

9.t1 Apply the definition and conditions stated in the chapter. For a calculation, show the relevant change and divide or multiply only after identifying the correct starting value and unit.

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CHAPTER X · COSTS OF PRODUCTION

10.t1 Apply the definition and conditions stated in the chapter. For a calculation, show the relevant change and divide or multiply only after identifying the correct starting value and unit.

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Elastic supply, 63

Elasticity, 40–48, 60, 62–67

Equilibrium, 52–53, 70–78

Equilibrium price, 71

Equilibrium quantity, 71

Excess demand, 70–73, 76

Excess supply, 70, 72, 76

Explicit cost, 91, 112, 115, 118

F

Factor of production, 3, 112

Factor price, 112

Firm, 2–7, 14–15, 17, 21–23, 26, 31–33, 37, 41–43, 47, 52–53, ...

Fixed cost, 90–94, 96

Fixed input, 82–83

G

Giffen good, 30, 34, 36

Good, 3–5, 12, 17, 20–21, 23, 30, 32–36, 40, 44, 46–48, ...

H

Household, 3–7, 14–15, 17, 21–23, 26, 31–33, 37, 40–43, 46–47, 52–53, ...

I

Implicit cost, 90–94, 96, 112, 115, 118

Income elasticity of demand, 44

Increasing returns to scale, 84

Indifference curve, 50–52, 54, 56–57

Indifference map, 52

Industry, 101, 106

Inelastic demand, 42–43

Inelastic supply, 63

Inferior good, 33–34

Input, 2, 7, 12, 17, 20, 26, 30, 37, 40, 47, ...

Interest, 112, 114–115, 118

Isocost line, 94, 96

Isoquant, 93, 96

L

Law of demand, 31–32

Law of diminishing marginal utility, 21–23

Law of diminishing returns, 83

Law of supply, 60–61

Least-cost combination, 90, 94–96

Long run, 80–82, 86–87, 90, 96, 100, 107

FURTHER READING

Alfred Marshall introduces elasticity of demand in Principles of Economics, 1890, historical case reference

David Ricardo's rent theory in his 1815 essay and his 1817 Principles, and the Corn Laws repealed in 1846, historical case reference

Jules Dupuit, 1844, on measuring the usefulness of public works such as bridge tolls, historical case reference

The marginal revolution of 1871 to 1874: Jevons, Menger and Walras explain the diamond-and-water puzzle, historical case reference

US petrol shortage after the October 1973 oil embargo, with queues and the odd-even plate rationing of 1974, historical case reference